

TRIMESTER 3
HISTORY OVERVIEW
2021-2022

Ancient Rome

This trimester, we focus on the Ancient Roman Empire, the foundation of Western civilization. The time frame from the traditional founding date of Rome until the fall of the Eastern Roman Empire (Byzantine Empire) spanned approximately 2200 years! How did that small Latin city-state of ancient Rome spawn an empire which would last through the Middle Ages? What impact does that ancient civilization still have on us today? These are some of the things that we will explore.

Our studies will cover three periods of ancient Rome:

1. Age of Kings (753-509 BCE) – The traditional founding date of Rome is 753 BCE. Archaeological evidence points to early settlements on the hills of Rome around the 10th century BC. The mythology associated with the founding of Rome centers upon the Trojan prince Aeneas and the wolf-suckled twins Remus and Romulus. The age of kings begins with Romulus, the 1st king until the expulsion of kings in 509 BC. Etruscans influenced much of this period -they provided 3 kings and skills with city planning, engineering, waterworks, and road works. An Etruscan king drained the marshy area of Rome and built the Forum over it.
2. Republic (509-27 BCE) – The Republic is founded after the expulsion of the kings. Consuls and magistrates take the place of kings. Rome dramatically expands during this time. It slowly but steadily gains control of the Italian peninsula. Victory over Carthage in the Punic Wars gives Rome its first provinces of Sicily, Spain, Africa, and the Mediterranean islands between Africa and Italy. Rome also gained contact with Hellenistic kingdoms in the eastern Mediterranean, leading to Rome's domination of the eastern Mediterranean. Rome made provinces of Macedonia, Pergamum, and Egypt, to name but a few. All of this brought much wealth to the Republic. However, the vast expansion of territory and the incredible acquisition of wealth strained the Republic, leading to many years of civil wars.
3. Imperial Rome (27 BCE-CE 476) – Beginning with the first Roman emperor, Octavian, the imperial period in the Latin west continued until the deposition of Romulus Augustus in 476 CE. The eastern Roman Empire continued its existence until its overthrow in 1453 CE by the Ottomans.

Octavian, conferred the name Augustus, brought peace and stability to Rome. But by the third century, during the “3rd-century crisis,” Rome was fighting to keep its borders intact. The “barbaric” Germanic tribes were pushing up against Rome’s northern frontiers,

along the Danube and Rhine rivers, by tribes further north. The Persians were also aggressive in the east. The combination of external pressure from foreign aggressors and internal stresses from civil wars over succession created a crisis in the Empire. Diocletian would gain and keep control long enough to stabilize the situation. Emperor Constantine would build an empire that tolerated Christianity, which allowed the numbers of followers to grow.

However, by late-4th to 5th century, the western empire was fragmenting. Roman armies left Britain by 410 to fight elsewhere in the empire. The Asiatic Huns were pushing the German Goths hard against the Roman frontier. Many barbarian mercenaries were used in the Roman armies because Rome lacked manpower. While there was a shortage of men for the armies, the Vandals and Goths were making inroads into the empire. Visigoths moved into Italy, sacking Rome in 410 CE. Vandals move into Gaul, Spain, and then North Africa. They sacked Rome in 455 CE. In the final years, Roman administration gradually disintegrated. Survival depended on volatile allies who easily reneged on their alliance when presented with opportunities to extend their lands. Emperor Romulus Augustus became the last western Roman emperor, deposed in 476 CE by Odoacer, a German officer who had served under Romulus' father.

The Eastern Roman Empire continued for another thousand years until it fell before the Ottomans in 1453. The Roman Empire had a 2200-year run, from 753 BCE-CE 1453, and became the foundation for Western Civilization.

3/21-22

Ancient Rome Etruscans

Date	2000-200s BCE
Themes	Trade and Commerce Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 27 (Romulus & Remus) OxR Ch 2 Etruscans

Geography of the Italian Peninsula

Geography did much to shape the history of Italy:

- Peninsula
 - Narrow, extending 750 miles from north to south, but averaging only 120 miles across
 - Jutting into the Mediterranean Sea – was an important crossroads between the eastern and western Mediterranean
 - When Rome was an empire, Italy was centrally located, making it easier to govern
- Apennine mountain range
 - Runs down the middle of the peninsula from north to south – forms a ridge dividing east from west
 - Pockets of fertile land but mountain range isolates communities
 - Isolation is not to the extent found in Greece – (the mountains were not a barrier to political unification) but was enough to create diversity, strong regional loyalties, and well-established local languages
 - Into the 20th century, Italian remained a 2nd language for many Italians
- Arable land
 - Coastal plains
 - Po Valley – in the north
 - The richest plain makes up 70% of lowland Italy
 - Plain of Latium – where Rome is located
 - Campania – south of Latium plain
 - Most fertile valley along western coast
 - Volcanic soil
 - Good rainfall
 - Mineral-rich (especially between the Tiber and Arno rivers)

- Greeks and Phoenicians traded with Etruscans for minerals

Early Settlers of Italy

Not much is known about the prehistoric peoples in Italy

- Indo-Europeans moved into Italy between 2000 and 1000 BCE
- By 1000 BCE, other peoples were settling – Etruscans(?), Greeks
 - Or, Etruscans were possibly aboriginal, living in the area before the Indo-Europeans arrived

Etruscans

The origins of the Etruscans are not clear:

- Spoke a non-Indo-European language
 - Greeks and Romans were Indo-European peoples
- Some postulate that Etruscans migrated from Asia Minor, but others believe they may have been indigenous – but no definitive proof of Etruscan origin

Etruscans had settled in Etruria (north of Rome) – roughly modern-day Tuscany

- By 1200 BCE, sophisticated & intensive agricultural economy capable of supporting a larger population
- By 900 BCE, grouped into villages –
 - then developed into cities with fortified walls, urbanizing northern and central Italy when most Italic peoples still lived in villages
 - Greece urbanized southern Italy during Greece's colonization period
- 700-500 BCE height of Etruscan civilization
 - At height of the civilization, had expanded from west coast up to Po valley, and south to Bay of Naples
 - By end of 8th century BCE, towns of Latium (including Rome) came under Etruscan control
- Adopted Euboean Greek alphabet between 700 and 600 BCE

Etruscan Society

- Made up of clans, each with their leader
 - An Etruscan identified himself with his clan rather than a particular city or Etruscan 'nation'. Later, the Romans also followed this practice.
 - In contrast with the Greeks, who identified with their poleis
- Government
 - Centralized government – government viewed as central authority over all tribal and clan organization

- Political unity = city-state
 - Monarchy changed into an oligarchic democracy in 6th century BCE (as did the Roman Republic)
- Etruscan symbols of state power adopted by the Romans: Toga Palmata, curule chair, fasces (bundle of whipping rods surrounded by double-bladed ax) carried by 'lictors.'
- City Planning
 - Etruscans were masters at city planning, engineering, and waterworks – Romans learned much from them
 - Etruscan king drained the marshy area of Rome and built the Forum over it
 - Etruscans' skills later helped Rome with its system of roads and waterways throughout the empire
- Family
 - Monogamous marriage
 - Tomb paintings depict:
 - Women treated with apparent affection and tenderness
 - Men with wives (not with 'hetairai,' the courtesans that the Greeks favored)
 - Lifestyle reminiscent of the aristocratic age of Greece (Odysseus and Penelope) rather than democratic Athens
 - Paintings show lifestyle of hunting and banqueting, sports, religious rituals

Trade

- Area rich in metals: iron, copper, and silver. Etruscans exchanged metals for pottery and finished metalwork
- Trade with Greece influenced Etruscan art and ideas
- Trade with early Romans brought Greek ideas/religion to Rome

Arts & Engineering

- Artists and metal workers made iron plows and polished bronze mirrors, silver bowls, and gold jewelry. Sculptors created masterpieces in bronze and clay.
 - Developed terracotta for use in decorating temples
 - Original Etruscan artistic creation is bucchero, a shiny black pottery
- Etruscans were brilliant architects – invented the arch and vault, which Romans later used to build their enormous arenas
 - Etruscans absorbed Greek influence in their architecture and had much influence over Roman architecture. Romans adopted Etruscan architecture, and through the Romans became the standard for western civilization.

Religion

- Polytheistic; pantheon of gods drawn from many sources, primarily local and Greek
 - 2/3 of the Olympian gods have an Etruscan equivalent

- Ritual very important
- Pleasures/displeasures of the gods determined by the flight of birds, lightning flashes, or other unusual events
 - Augurs prescribe rituals for appeasement
 - Augurs performed their duties on sacred high ground (area known as templum to the Romans – origin of the word 'temple')
 - Etruscan rules of divination preserved by Romans

In the 550s BCE, Etruscans were threatened by Greeks fleeing the expansion of the Persian Empire, Carthaginians, Samnites, and Celtic warbands. Even though Rome conquered the Etruscans in the 3rd century, Etruscan influence remained in the Roman culture.

Someone once said that the most famous Etruscan creation was Rome.

3/23-24

Ancient Rome Founding of Rome

Date	Traditionally 753 BCE Earliest archaeological evidence of people on site c. 1500 BCE
Themes	Philosophy and Religion Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 27 (Power of Rome) OxR Ch 1

Roman Foundation Myth

According to Dio Cassius, a Roman historian who wrote an 80-volume Roman History covering the founding of Rome through the reign of Emperor Alexander Severus. The following is found in Fragments of Book I from his Roman History

“But the history of the Romans begins with Numitor and Amulius, who were grandsons of Aventinus and descendants of Aeneas.

So much regarding Alba and the Albans; the story of Rome now begins. Aventinus begat Numitor and Amulius, - or Procas, according to some; and the man's sons, they say, were the aforesaid Numitor and Amulius. Numitor while king was driven out by Amulius, who killed Numitor's son Aegestes on a hunting party and made Silvia, or Rhea Ilia, the sister of Aegestes, and daughter of the aforesaid Numitor, a priestess of Vesta, so that she might remain a virgin. For he stood in dread of an oracle which declared that he should be slain by the children of Numitor. It was for this reason that he killed Aegestes and made his sister priestess of Vesta, that she might continue a virgin and childless. But she while drawing water in Mars' grove conceived, and bore Romulus and Remus. The daughter of Amulius by her entreaties saved her from being put to death but the babes were given to Faustulus, a shepherd, husband of Laurentia, to be exposed beside the river Tiber. These the shepherd's wife took and reared; for it happened that she had at that time borne a dead child. When Romulus and Remus were grown they kept flocks in the fields of Amulius, but as they killed some of the shepherds of their grandfather Numitor, a watch was set for them. When Remus was arrested, Romulus ran and told Faustulus, and he ran and related the whole story to Numitor. Finally Numitor recognized them as his own daughter's children. They with the assistance of many others killed Amulius, and after bestowing the kingdom of Alba on their grandfather Numitor made a beginning themselves of founding Rome in the eighteenth year of Romulus' life. [But prior to this great Rome,] which Romulus founded on the palatine mount near the dwelling of Faustulus, [another Rome in the form of a square had been founded by a Romulus and Remus more ancient than these.]

Among these [i.e., children suckled by animals], according to Dio, were also the founder of Rome (that is to say, Remus and Romulus), who were suckled by a she-wolf, called by the Italians *lupa*; this name has been aptly applied as a term for courtesans.”

Another version

Aeneas, a Trojan prince, son of Anchises and the goddess Aphrodite, escaped the sack of Troy and fled to Italy with his family. The son of Aeneas, Iulius (Julius), founded Alba Longa, an ancient city of Latium.

Years later, Rhea Silvia, a daughter of the king of Alba Longa and direct descendant of Aeneas, gives birth to twin boys: Romulus and Remus. As for who fathered the boys, there is much variation. Some stories claim Mars, others Hercules. Livy relates that an unknown man raped Rhea Silvia, but that pregnancy resulted from divine conception. Regardless of who the father was, she gave birth to Romulus and Remus.

Rhea Silvia's uncle had overthrown her father, the king of Alba Longa. In his effort to eliminate all potential heirs to the throne, her uncle killed her brothers and forced her to become a Vestal Virgin. Because she was supposed to be celibate as a Vestal Virgin, she was punished after she gave birth with imprisonment and the twins were to be thrown into the Tiber River. However, a servant spared their lives by putting them in a basket before casting them onto the river. The basket alighted on the bank of the river, ensnared in roots of a fig tree at the base of Palatine hill. Discovered by a she-wolf, she suckled the twins, and a woodpecker fed them. They stayed alive between the wolf and the woodpecker until a shepherd found them. The shepherd and his wife raised the boys.

The twins grew up and left Alba Longa to establish a new city. They both searched for the best location but quarreled over whose site was best. Romulus wanted to build on the Palatine Hill, but Remus insisted upon the Aventine Hill. The argument ended in murder. Romulus murdered his brother Remus and became the first king of Rome. Livy dates the founding of Rome to April 21st, 753 BCE.

The legend of Romulus and Remus had been a well-known foundation myth for the Romans. When Octavian became the first emperor, he wanted an epic poem written on behalf of Rome. Virgil wrote the Aeneid, giving the Romans a grand mythic epic to rival Homer's efforts for the Greeks.

Review of Early history of Rome:

- Early records of Rome were destroyed, so it is challenging to construct early Roman history
 - Later Roman historians drew on various legends from both Greek and Roman sources
- Earliest archaeological evidence of habitation in Latium dates from the Bronze Age, likely Latin-speaking herdsmen or farmers. Development into an urban settlement was gradual. The earliest established permanent settlement began in the 8th century BC.

- Evidence of people living on-site that Rome sits c. 1500 BCE, most likely itinerant pastoralists
 - Rome grew up on the banks of the Tiber River as a scattering of villages on low-lying hills ('seven hills of Rome'). Possibly by 1000 BCE, there were 2 villages on the Palatine and Esquiline hills.
 - Inhabitants of some of these Latin villages united and established a common meeting place, the Forum, around which the city of Rome grew.
- Tradition states that Rome was founded in 753 BCE. This is in the ballpark of archaeological evidence for a permanent settlement.

Age of Kings

c. 753-509 BCE – Rome ruled by kings

- Not much is known about them, or exactly how many there were, but archaeology supports the rule of kings during this period
- Kingship was not hereditary
- Each king, rex, chosen by comitia curiata (an assembly of ~30 clans) after auspices taken –
 - The king now had imperium – divine authority to command
- Tradition holds that there were 7 legendary kings – the 3 groups of early 'Italy' were represented: 2 were Latin, 2 were Sabine, and 3 were Etruscan
 - Romulus (753-717 BCE)
 - Legendary founder of Rome; possibly shared power with king of the Sabines
 - Legendary founder of the senate – initially 100 members called patres ("fathers"), likely heads of leading families and elderly men who advised the king. Patricians come from patres. (Senatus is derived from senex, "old man")
 - Numa Pompilius (715-673 BCE)
 - Tullis Hostilus (673-642 BCE)
 - Ancus Marcius (642-617 BCE)
 - Lucinius Tarquinius Priscus (616-585 BCE)
 - Ordered the 1st public embellishment of Rome – Forum paved, ceremonial buildings (temples, sanctuaries) built around the Forum, and an open area cleared for citizens assemblies
 - Servius Tullius (578-535 BCE)
 - Created a citizen army – the 1st legion
 - Became customary to call the centuries to meet on the Field of Mars, outside of the city wall
 - Eventually called the comitia centuriata – one of the most powerful of the citizen assemblies, with the power to declare war or make alliances

- During the Republic, they formed the electoral body for consuls and praetors. Expansion of citizen bodies was crucial to Rome's later success. Even freed slaves could become citizens (to the horror of the Greeks!)
- Lucius Tarquinius "The Proud" (531-509 BCE)
 - Tyrannical king who was thrown out when, according to legend, his son Sextus raped Lucretia

The Romans threw off the mantle of kingship. The Age of Kings had passed – Rome became a republic. It was a source of great pride for the Romans that they had freed themselves from royal rule, much as it had for modern Americans, writes historian Matthew Kneale.

3/28-29

Roman Republic Beginning of the Republic & Roman Gods

Date	509-265 BCE
Themes	Philosophy and Religion Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 28 (Gods) OxR Ch 3, 5

The Republic – “Senatus et Populus Que Romanum”

(SPQR: The Senate and the People of Rome)

res publica, ‘the public matter.’

Once the kings were banished (likely by the aristocrats – aristocratic takeovers were common in Italian and Greek city-states of the late 6th century BCE), Rome was challenged by nearby Latin tribes. Political institutions evolved in response to problems as they arose. Leadership was shared between the senate, consuls, and the popular assembly, to prevent the chance of any one person taking control and ruling as a tyrant.

Rome became a Republic – a state where the highest power belonged to citizens. Citizenship was acquired through birth, naturalization, or if a slave- through manumission by his master. The popular assembly was made of citizens (primarily wealthy landowners) and men entitled to vote. The chief magistrates (consuls) who were invested with imperium held office for limited terms and could be tried for offenses after their term. The senate advised the consuls.

Structure of Government

Magistrates

- 2 Consuls – replaced the king
 - Chief magistrates with imperium – the right to command (previously held by king)
 - 2 are chosen annually and cannot be immediately reelected – each consul could check the other’s action
 - The legion is split into 2 smaller legions, each available to a consul

As Rome expanded –other magistracies were established:

- Quaestor – administrators of financial affairs
 - Originally 2 elected; in 421 BCE, 4 annually elected (later, as many as 20 as the republic grew larger)

- Censor – maintained records of citizenship and listed those eligible for military
- Praetor – execution of judicial affairs in 366 BCE.
 - Also possessed imperium and could govern Rome when consuls were away from Rome
- Proconsul and Propraetor – ex-consuls and praetors who served their one term were given a new title and sent to govern as provincial governors
 - Necessary as Rome conquered and acquired provinces

Senate

Was a deliberative body (not legislative) used for discussions in making policies

- Very influential - most legislation was not passed unless the senate gave its approval
- Former magistrates joined the senate for life after completion of their term in office
 - Therefore, the senate contained a vast reservoir of collective experience, providing stability during tumultuous years

Popular Assemblies

Made up of citizens with the right to vote – wealthy males, usually landowners

- Centuriate Assembly (comitia centuriata)– most important
 - Roman army in its political role
 - Elected the magistrates/consuls
 - Organized by classes based on wealth
- Council of the Plebs (concilium plebs) – 471 BCE
 - Assembly for the plebeians – formed after the 1st Secession of the Plebeians

Dictator

- During an emergency, the consul resigns, and a dictator is chosen to run the state
- Term limit usually 6 months

To recap-

Republican Rome Government – 3 primary elements:

1. Consuls/magistrates – ran the administration of the state
2. Assemblies – elected the above officials
3. Senate – small group (mostly patricians) who advised consuls/magistrates

Therefore, the Roman state = an aristocratic republic controlled by a small group of privileged people

Historian Edward Watts (author of *Mortal Republic*) reminds his students and readers that no republic is eternal. It lives only as long as its citizens want it. Rome shows:

- The basic, most important function of a republic is to create a political space that is governed by laws that
- Foster compromise
- Shares governing responsibility among a group of representatives
- Rewards good stewardship
- Politics in such a republic is not a zero-sum game

The Roman Republic didn't encourage its leaders to seek complete and total victory. It offered tools that served to keep the process of political negotiation going until a mutually agreeable compromise was found.

This process worked well for Rome for centuries – but it only worked because most Roman politicians accepted the laws and the norms of the Republic. Republican Rome succeeded in this more than perhaps any other state before or since.

The early and middle centuries of Rome's republic show how effective this system could be – the last century of the Roman Republic reveals the tremendous dangers that result when political leaders misuse these consensus-building mechanisms to obstruct a republic's functions.

The Roman Republic was rocked by a series of political murders in the 130s and 120s BCE. Within 2 generations, Rome fell into civil war. Two generations later, Augustus ruled as Roman Emperor.

Roman Religion

"We have overcome all the nations of the world, because we have realized that the world is directed and governed by the gods." ~Cicero

As in Greek society, every aspect of Roman society was permeated with religion. Roman religion was a blend of Etruscan and early Latin tribal beliefs. Romans were usually tolerant of other religious cults, and as Romans encountered Greeks, an amalgamation of Greek and Roman religion occurred.

Sometimes the original name of the god/goddess remained the same, and at other times was replaced by a Roman name. The following lists the major Roman deities with the Greek deity equivalent:

<u>Roman</u>	<u>Greek</u>	<u>Domain</u>
Jupiter	Zeus	king of the gods
Juno	Hera	wife of Zeus/Jupiter
Venus	Aphrodite	goddess of beauty and love
Mars	Ares	god of war
Diana	Artemis	goddess of hunting and childbirth

Minerva	Athena	goddess of war, wisdom, craft
Ceres	Demeter	god of harvest, grain
Pluto	Hades	god of the underworld
Mercury	Hermes	messenger god, god of merchants
Saturn	Kronos	god of agriculture
Neptune	Poseidon	god of the sea

Household cults

- Many gods originated in the home and reflected the needs of a community dependent upon agriculture
 - Janus – spirit of the doorway
 - Vesta – goddess of the hearth
 - Lares – spirits of land that protected the household
 - Penates – spirits of the store cupboard
- Paterfamilias – as head of the family, the father ensured the religious obligations of the household were fulfilled

State Religion - Religious ritual helped maintain the cohesion of the state

Romans believed humans depended on the gods, so performing rituals was crucial to establish the right relationship with the gods. Therefore, the state also needed to perform rituals to achieve its goals:

- College of priests (pontiffs) - performed public religious acts, determined dates of festivals, kept records of religious events
 - Pontifex maximus = chief priest, most powerful religious official in Roman society
- College of augurs – religious officers who read and interpreted signs by “taking auspices” (reading god’s will from the flight pattern of birds, changes in weather, feeding habits of sacred chickens, lightning)
 - Auspices were taken before any major event: sea voyages, war, important elections
 - Before every important act of state, a magistrate with imperium took the auspices to make sure of gods’ approval
- Vestal Virgins
 - A group of 6 respected, sacred women whose duty it was to maintain and care for holy fire in the state Temple of Vesta in the Forum in Rome

- Pontifex Maximus chose girls between 6-10 years old; they served for 30 years (10 years in training, 10 years performing duties, and 10 years in teaching the next group)
- Flamines – officials appointed to serve individual state gods in Rome (ancient writers refer to 15 flamines who served the “official” Roman deities)
- Religious festivals
 - Public – ordained and paid for by the state
 - Private – celebrated by individuals/families
 - Practice of holding games came out of religious festivals – by late Republic, the # of festivals and length of duration increased

3/30-31

Roman Republic Class Conflict

Date	500-450 BCE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 28 (Builders) OxR Ch 4

Since the expulsion of the kings, Rome was in constant warfare (which would extend throughout the 5th century BCE) –

- Defensive wars after the overthrow of their kings (other tribes believed Rome vulnerable and ripe for takeover)
- Wars of conquest to expand territory

Incessant warfare caused great economic distress for the poorer people, leading to conflict between wealthy patricians and poorer plebeians.

Social Organization of Rome

2 Main Classes or Orders

- Patricians
 - Families descended from the original senators appointed during the period of kings – made up mostly of wealthy landowners = an aristocratic governing class
- Plebeians (“plebs”)
 - Group of “independent, unprivileged, poorer” non-patrician landowners, artisans, and merchants

Beginning of the 5th century BCE, a struggle to equalize the situation began

- Landowning plebeians equal in wealth to patricians led to the struggle for plebeian rights

The Struggle of the Orders

Main issues fueling the class conflict-

1. Both patricians and plebs could vote, but only patricians could be elected to government offices
2. Marriage between plebeians and patricians were banned
3. Plebeians were in economic distress from constant warfare, land-hunger, and debt:
 - The wars left the plebeians in a desperate position. While most wealthy lived in the city walls, their property was protected by the city walls. Most plebeians lived in the country; while they were serving in the army, their farms were neglected, and homes were destroyed

- Having lost their property, the plebeians had to borrow money from wealthy patricians. If he couldn't repay his debt, he was subject to arrest, imprisonment, or slavery. It was difficult to escape from this continual poverty.
- Land acquired from conquest during the wars was considered public lands. The land might have been used justly to relieve the stress on the poor, especially those who lost their land while fighting for Rome. But the patricians took control of most of the land, enabling them to become even richer.

Plebs wanted political equality (right to hold office) and social equality (right of intermarriage), and economic opportunity

Plebeians challenge the Patricians!

First Secession of the Plebeians

- 494 BCE – Rome was at war. To get the attention of the patricians, the plebeians refused to mobilize – instead, they left the city, marching to a hill about 3 miles from Rome, called the Sacred Mount. Patricians realized that the loss of the plebeian army meant Rome's destruction – so they were compelled to make a settlement with the plebeians:
 - Debts of the insolvent were canceled; those imprisoned for debt were released
 - Tribune – new office created for the benefit of the plebeians
 - 2 new officers (plebeian) appointed as Tribunes to protect plebeians from oppression by patrician magistrates
 - Tribunes had power to veto – to forbid – the act of any magistrate which bore unjustly upon any citizen
 - Any harm to a tribune while holding office was punishable by death.
 - Aediles – assistants to the tribunes, chosen from the plebeian body
 - Plebeian Assembly –
 - Meetings that plebeians had held occasionally now became a permanent assembly (concilium plebis), recognized by the patricians ~471 BCE
 - Tribunes could call an assembly. Resolutions passed would be binding on plebeians, but not on all Romans yet (that would not occur until 287 BCE, a landmark for Roman constitutional law)

The Law of the Twelve Tables – Foundation for Roman law

Derived from ancient legislation that was the foundation of Roman law and which formed the centerpiece for the constitution of the Roman Republic

450 BCE – Continued plebeian agitation brought about the Twelve Tables, the first time Roman law was written down. The plebeians had been at a great disadvantage – the patricians

administered the law as they saw fit but kept the knowledge of the law to themselves. The laws had never been written down. The plebeians wanted them published. The tables reveal a brutal society.

The patricians appointed a board of ten men (decemviri) to draw up the first ten tables in 451 BCE. In 450 BCE, a second decemviri drew up the last 2 tables.

- According to Livy, the laws were engraved on 12 bronze tablets and attached to the Rostra in the Forum
- Laws were not new but were the 1st time the customary laws were published
- The publication of the laws caused more strife – plebs could plainly see how disadvantaged they were! However, slowly but surely, progress was made towards equalizing the classes:
 - 445 BCE – intermarriage between patricians and plebeians allowed
 - 367 BCE – consulship open to plebs
 - 342 BCE – at least 1 of the 2 consuls had to be plebeian
 - 287 BCE – all laws passed in the plebeian assembly were legally binding to ALL Romans (not just the plebs), and these laws didn't need senate approval!

Sampling of laws from the Twelve Tables:

- A dreadfully deformed child shall be killed
- Females, by reason of levity of their disposition, shall remain in guardianship, even when they have maintained their majority
- Whoever is convicted of speaking false witness shall be flung from the Tarpeian Rock
- A person committing burglary in the night may be lawfully killed
- A thief in the daytime may not be killed unless he carried a weapon

The struggle of the orders had been handled by compromise – not violent revolution. By 287 BCE, all Roman citizens were equal under the law. Quite an achievement!

- Although the wealthy still dominated the political offices, wealthier plebeians became integrated into the ruling classes (magistracies and senate)

(Primary/Intermediate level will be covering Romans as Builders)

Roman Builders-

Demonstrated exceptional coordination of men and resources before modern machinery

- Roads
- Aqueducts
- Public baths
- Basilicas
- Bridges
- Harbors
- Colosseum and other amphitheaters

New technologies and innovations made their massive building projects possible-

- Concrete – discovered that lime +volcanic ash created a durable concrete that sets underwater
 - June 2013 - Berkeley Lab scientists released results of their research into the exact composition of Roman concrete, stating that it could replace 40% of the world's demand for Portland cement. (Modern concrete lasts 50-100 years, whereas Roman concrete has shown a 2,000-year track record and is still going strong!)
- Domes – an architectural innovation
- Arches and vaults– an architectural innovation taken from the Etruscans, used on a grand scale
- Sewage systems
- Central heating systems

An excavated Roman home from the 380s BCE is indicative of the classic Italian design:

- A spacious villa and garden
- Reception room
- Large hall with opening in roof for rainwater collection into a pool below
- Hypocaust heating systems

4/4-5

Roman Republic Conquest of the Mediterranean The Punic Wars and the Aftermath

Date	267-133 BCE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	SOTW Ch 29 OxR Ch 6, 7

The Gauls (Celts) in northern Italy

- Language similar to the Latins
 - 1500 years earlier, the Latins and Gauls probably one people)
- Gauls sacked Rome in 387/390 BCE
 - Rome had negligible defenses
 - City was hardly damaged, though. No evidence of burning. Gauls may have been paid to leave the city alone.
 - The sacking greatly affected the Romans. It was one of their few losses and left a new sense of fear. Dreaded the thought of the Celts' return to destroy the city.
- After Gallic attack on Rome-
 - Rome's defenses were fortified
 - The army was reorganized
 - Net effect: Gauls made Rome stronger; gave them courage and grit
- Rome went on defeat the Samnites, Etruscans, King Pyrrhus's Greeks, Carthaginians
- By early 2nd century BCE, all of Gallic northern Italy was subjugated; however, the Romans distrusted them, and they were the last people in Italy to be given citizenship.

Celtic Italy Romanized

- After attaining citizenship, the Gauls studied Latin (conveniently a language close to Latin)
- Watched Roman entertainments
- Gave children a Roman education
- Worshipped Roman gods
- Lived in cities modeled after those of Rome
- Eventually identified themselves as Roman – a complete Roman victory!

Postscript to the Gauls

- Julius Caesar would conquer Gallic France
- Celtic lands in central Europe would be taken by the Germans, the “new barbarians on the block”

Roman Conquest of Italy (quick overview)

When the Roman republic began, Rome was surrounded by enemies-

- North – Etruscans
- East & South – Sabines, Volscians, Aequi
- Plain of Latium – other Latin tribes

By 340 BCE – Romans established supremacy in Latium
290 BCE – conquered Samnites, giving control of a large part of central Italy
267 BCE – conquered southern Italy
264 BCE – conquered the last of the Etruscans in north
Rome now in control of all of Italy (except for the extreme north)

To rule Italy – Rome created a Roman confederation:

- Some (especially Latins) became full Roman citizens
- Most remaining communities were made Roman allies
 - Free to run their affairs
 - Required to provide soldiers for Rome
 - Future citizenship a possibility

Roman Conquest of the Mediterranean

Punic Wars

After the conquest of Italy, Rome faced Carthage – a major Mediterranean power

Carthage

- A former Phoenician colony on the Mediterranean coast (in modern-day Tunisia in North Africa) founded in 800 BCE by, according to legend, Queen Dido.
 - Originally, a small port used by Phoenician trade ships for repair and resupply
 - When the Phoenician city of Tyre fell to Alexander the Great in 332 BCE, those who were able fled to Carthage. With the wealth they could carry, these refugees established Carthage as the new Phoenician trade center.
 - Within a hundred years, Carthage was the wealthiest city in the Mediterranean.
- Became a strong military state by 3rd century BCE
 - Best navy in the region
 - Navy used for both defense and conquest
- Held a monopoly on western Mediterranean trade – largest & richest state
 - Positioned favorably on the Mediterranean coast for trade
 - Had an immense harbor, fitted with 220 docks

- Empire covered: north African coast, southern Spain, Sardinia, Corsica, western Sicily
 - Romans were apprehensive about Carthaginians in Sicily – too close for comfort! Much tension between Rome and Carthage...

1st Punic War (264-241 BCE)

(Latin for Phoenician was Punicus)

The catalyst for the war was a relatively insignificant incident, but given the tensions already existing between Carthage and Rome, it was enough to spark 23 years of war:

- Italian mercenaries, the Mamertines, seized Messana at the eastern tip of Sicily, overlooking the Strait of Messina. (The narrow passage between Messana and southern Italy was ~3 miles). The Mamertines massacred citizens and took their wives and property.
- 265 BCE - King Hiero of Syracuse tried to take control of Messana
- The Mamertines at Messana appealed to both Carthage and Rome for help
 - The Carthaginian military command in western Sicily sent a small force to garrison Messana
 - The senate in Rome debated the issue of sending aid – those who wanted military glory were in favor. In contrast, others who remembered the atrocious seizure of Messana by the mercenaries didn't want to give them aid. Also, a consideration was that a Carthaginian takeover of Messana would threaten Rome's control of the Messina Strait between Sicily and Italy.
 - Senate deadlocked – consuls turned to the popular assembly for direction
 - With the promise of war booty, the assembly approved the sending of a Roman force – the only known example of a citizen assembly (rather than the senate) initiating a war
- Rome at war with Carthage – beginning of 1st Punic War
 - Rome sent a force to Messana, Carthage withdrew
 - Carthage and Syracuse, traditionally enemies, now allied against Rome

263 BCE – Rome sent 40,000 men. With the coming of the Romans, many Greek Sicilian cities defected from Syracuse to the Romans.

- King Hiero of Syracuse, feeling isolated and unsure of victory, sues for peace with Rome.
- Rome and Syracuse now allies
- Roman forces take Carthaginian garrison of Agragas – city sacked, and all 25,000 of its occupants are sold into slavery

War was at a stalemate – without sea power, Rome could never take the advantage. So, Rome, with no naval tradition, shipbuilding experience, or trained crews, builds a navy!

- Used a grounded Carthaginian quinquereme as a model

- Added a Roman innovation – the *corvus*, “the crow”
 - A boarding bridge was kept vertical until needed during battle when it would be lowered and fastened onto the enemy’s deck to allow the boarding of Roman soldiers. (This helped the Romans overcome their disadvantages of poor ship maneuverability, slowness, and inexperienced naval crews).
- The battle then became hand-to-hand combat, like fighting on land. Carthaginian marines were taken by surprise:
 - “...the Roman crews boarded by means of the crows and attacked them hand-to-hand on deck, some of the Carthaginians were cut down, and others surrendered from dismay at what was happening, the battle having become just like a fight on land.” ~ *Polybius*
- War could now be fought at sea – Romans were victorious if they could avoid being rammed and get their troops on board the enemy deck to capture the ship.

A War of Attrition

Both Rome and Carthage had successes – war became one of attrition. Rome was exhausted, and Carthage was having difficulty finding mercenaries.

- 242 BCE – Finally, the Roman fleet decisively defeated the Carthaginian navy. Carthage sued for peace.
- 241 BCE – peace terms: Carthage lost Sicily paid an indemnity to cover Roman costs. Carthage itself remained unconquered, and her merchant fleets continued to generate wealth.

Impact of 1st Punic War

- Rome won income
- Rome gained her 1st province (Sicily) – a first step in building an empire
- Rome learned how to make war at sea
- Rome learned how to conduct war on a massive scale: the senate learned how to finance such a war, find men for armies, supplies, build fleets, and how conduct politics on the home front in times of such a war

3 years later, Rome took Sardinia and Corsica from Carthage – adding new Roman provinces and angering the Carthaginians

2nd Punic War (218-202 BCE)

Carthage began building a new empire in Spain under Hamilcar of Barca. With Spain came Spanish bullion, cavalry, and a field army forged with great skill and experience.

- 221 BCE – Hannibal (Hamilcar’s son) assumed control of Carthaginian Spain
 - Hannibal learned much from his father. He had left North Africa at the age of 9, growing up among the troops on campaign in Spain.

- Had a tutor from Sparta and admired the campaigns of Alexander the Great
- Changed the training of his army:
 - Dropped the standard Greek phalanx and created smaller, flexible units based on the ethnic group of his mercenaries
 - Combination of an energetic cavalry and his tactical genius was to underlie his success

Carthage and Rome in Spain-

- Saguntum was in Carthage's sphere of territory in Spain, but Rome had earlier allied with Saguntum (which didn't want to be under Carthaginian rule). Rome now encouraged residents to participate in anti-Carthaginian activities to provoke Carthage.
- Hannibal attacked Saguntum
- Rome declared war on Carthage (218 BCE)

Carthage's strategy – bring war to Italy

- Rome sent Publius Cornelius Scipio to Spain to fight Hannibal
- Hannibal decided to cross the Alps into Italy, hoping to destroy Rome's links with her allies. He started across the Alps with 38,000 infantry + 8,000 cavalry and some elephants –
 - 20,000 infantry and 6,000 cavalry (and elephants) finished the crossing to advance into northern Italy
 - Extremely difficult crossing, requiring Herculean efforts – it would not be until the reign of Emperor Augustus (31 BCE-CE 14) that a Roman would traverse the Alps
- Scipio sent his army on to Spain while he returned to Italy to meet Hannibal
- 218 BCE Battle of Trebia – Hannibal met the Romans at Trebia, soundly defeating them. Rome lost half her army and the north of Italy.
- 217 BCE Battle of Lake Trasimene – Hannibal slaughtered the Roman forces in central Italy at Lake Trasimene

Roman Emergency -

The Romans were desperate. They appointed Quintus Fabius Maximus as dictator for a 6-month term. He advocated avoiding large, fixed battles – instead, gradually wearing out the Carthaginians with smaller battles. They shadowed Hannibal's army, picking off raiding parties when able. This strategy wore down the Carthaginian army slowly and effectively, becoming known as Fabian tactics. The Romans didn't appreciate this strategy and replaced him when his term was over.

- George Washington, when facing overwhelming odds while fighting the British during the American Revolution, employed Fabian tactics

And the war continues...

- 216 BCE – Battle of Cannae: Romans defeated once again, losing 40,000 men
 - Hannibal consolidated his position in southern Italy, gaining Capua. However, Rome's allies remained with Rome
- Fabius Maximus elected consul and given command – employs Fabian tactics once again
- Hannibal was now on the defensive. He held no ports, thus unable to break out of southern Italy. He roamed Italy but lacked men and equipment to conquer major cities. Now it is a war of attrition.
 - Hannibal occupied Italy for ~16 years!

Meanwhile, in Spain...

- 211 BCE – Rome almost lost her hold in Spain, but Publius Cornelius Scipio was sent back and given command
 - Brilliant commander – learned from Hannibal
 - By 206 BCE – Carthaginians were out of Spain

On to Carthage –

- 204 BCE – Scipio led Roman legions to North Africa
 - Carthage recalls Hannibal from Italy
 - Quite a feat – took Hannibal 2 years to maneuver his army of 20,000 to a seaport undetected, then wait for the fleet to arrive from Carthage undetected
- 202 BCE Battle of Zama –the showdown between Scipio and Hannibal. Hannibal's army is destroyed, and Carthage surrenders. Scipio awarded the name 'Africanus' in recognition of his victory
- 201 BCE – peace treaty signed
 - Carthage lost Spain
 - Loss of all islands between Africa and Italy
 - Paid indemnity 10x larger than that required in 241 peace treaty
 - Carthage was forbidden from fighting wars outside of Africa and needed Rome's permission to fight in Africa
 - Fleet reduced to 10 warships

Impact of 2nd Punic War

- Rome gained a new province of Spain
- Rome gained the islands between Africa and Italy
 - In 50 years, Rome had acquired most of the western Mediterranean!
 - These territories were conquered lands – they needed large armies to secure them. Therefore, the army continued to play a crucial role in Roman society.

3rd Punic War (and Cato's influence) (149-146 BCE)

Despite penalties from the 2nd Punic War, Carthage paid off her war indemnity, continued trade, and flourished economically. Free of the burdens and responsibilities of an empire, Carthage had rebuilt her economy in peace, while wars in Greece and Asia drained Rome.

- This didn't sit well with many Roman senators, who were jealous of Carthage's success. Senate's relations with Carthage were tense and hostile. Roman foreign policy became more aggressive.
 - Rome supported her Numidian ally Masinissa – even discreetly encouraging the Numidian invasion of Carthaginian lands. Numidia launched incursions into Carthaginian territory every decade since the 2nd Punic War.
- During the 150s, there was increased Numidian activity. Carthage's requests for aid from Rome were denied. According to the peace treaty, Carthage could not fight in Africa without Rome's permission, so finding a resolution was difficult without Roman intervention.
 - 153 BCE – Cato the Elder was part of a Roman delegation sent to Rome. (Carthage would rue the day that Cato the Elder became part of the delegation!) Cato became disturbed by the wealth and prosperity of Carthage. It became his mission to instigate war with Carthage. He ended every speech with, "Besides which, my opinion is that Carthage must be destroyed." (He also made the senate aware of the agricultural riches that would be Rome's if Carthage was destroyed).

The excuse that Rome was waiting for...

- 151 BCE – Masinissa of Numidia once again attacked a Carthaginian town. Knowing that seeking Roman intervention was futile, Carthage attacked the Numidians. By attacking Roman allies, Rome declared this a violation of the treaty made in 201. Rome now had her justification for war.
- 149 BCE – Rome declares war on Carthage. Sent 2 consular armies.
- 146 BCE – After a few years of minor battles, the Senate sent Public Cornelius Scipio Aemilianus (Scipio the Younger) to take command. He was successful in the assault on Carthage. A city of 700,000 was reduced to 50,000. Upon surrender, all who were left alive in the city were sold into slavery.
 - Polybius was an eyewitness to the sacking of Carthage. His account is lost, but Plutarch recounts Scipio's words to his tutor Polybius while the two of them were witnessing the destruction of Carthage:
 - "...Turning around to me (Polybius) at once and grasping my hand, Scipio said, 'A glorious moment, Polybius; but I have a dread foreboding that someday the same doom will be pronounced on my own country.' "
 - An excerpt from Appian's Roman History
 - "Scipio, beholding this city, which had flourished 700 years from its foundation and had ruled over so many lands, islands, and seas, as rich in

arms and fleets, elephants, and money as the mightiest empires, but far surpassing them in hardihood and high spirit...now come to its end in total destruction-Scipio, beholding this spectacle, is said to have shed tears and publicly lamented the fortune of the enemy. After meditating by himself a long time and reflecting on the inevitable fall of cities, nations, and empires, as well as the individuals, upon the fate of Troy, that once proud city, upon the fate of the Assyrian, the Median, and afterwards of the great Persian empire, and, most recently of all, of the splendid empire of Macedon, either voluntarily or otherwise the words of the poet [Homer, Iliad] escaped his lips: 'The day shall come in which our sacred Troy and Priam, and the people over whom Spear-bearing Priam rules, shall perish all.'"

Impact of 3rd Punic War

- Rome gained the new province of Africa

What did NOT happen

- Rome did NOT sow salt in the soil of Carthage
 - Nothing in ancient literature suggests that Rome salted the earth around Carthage.
 - This misconception may have been initiated through the writings of German historian Ferdinand Gregorovius in the 19th century. This was the first reference to salting the soil of Carthage after its downfall.
 - Also, it would have been highly unlikely for two very pragmatic reasons –
 - Salt is expensive and valuable. It would have taken a tremendous amount of salt to ruin the soil. The Romans would not have spent the money or used that valuable resource.
 - Romans needed grain for their growing empire. They would not have destroyed such valuable agricultural land. Twenty-five years after Carthage's destruction, Gaius Gracchus tried to start a Roman colony there. Gracchus would not have even attempted if salt had been sown into the earth. Julius Caesar and emperor Augustus founded 19 colonies between them in the province, including a new Carthage. Subsequent emperors expanded the territory, which provided many agricultural products for the empire.

Eastern Mediterranean

The Punic Wars had brought Rome into contact with Hellenistic kingdoms. After the defeat of Carthage, Rome advocated for the freedom of Greek states from the Macedonian and Seleucid empires.

- 148 BCE – Macedonia made a Roman province
- 133 BCE – king of Pergamum gave his kingdom to Rome = 1st Asian province

Overview of Roman Imperialism

3 stages

- Conquest of Italy
- Conflict with Carthage and expansion into the western Mediterranean (pacification of Spain)
- Domination of Hellenistic kingdoms in the eastern Mediterranean

Impact of Imperialism-

- Rapid growth
- Senators saw opportunities for lucrative foreign commands, war booty, and enslaved people for their estates
- Vast amounts of plunder poured into Italy – adding to Rome’s wealth
 - Including hundreds of thousands of slaves from Africa, Spain, and the east – creates a new economy based on continuing slave labor
- Eastern culture floods into Rome: Greek art, drama, architecture, education
 - Many Romans felt traditional values threatened
- Destruction of Carthage and Corinth shows the growing arrogance and brutality of Rome
- Affirmed Roman domination of the Mediterranean world
- Roman governors controlled Macedonia and North Africa
 - Taxes collected from Macedonia and North Africa support the Roman army, fuels a rapidly developing Roman economy

An empire like Rome now possessed should have:

- A permanent administration to collect taxes, promote commerce, and convey information from the outer regions back to the capital
 - Instead of expanding its administration to meet the needs of the newly acquired territory and its populace, the maintenance of the infrastructure was outsourced to private contractors
 - Roman contractors ran the mines, built the roads, collected taxes – but lax monitoring by the magistrates enabled contractors as well as provincial governors to pocket huge sums of money corruptly

Rome had been at war for over 100 years. War had taken its toll – the city ruled a large empire with a government designed to govern a city-state. The strains would prove too great for the Republic. Significant portions of the population were frustrated at the Republic’s inability to police corruption and inequality resulting from Rome’s rapid economic and military expansion. One hundred years later, the Republic would fall apart.

4/6-7

Roman Republic The Gracchi and Decline of Republic

Date	133-122 BCE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 34 (Rise of Caesar) OxR Ch 9

Beginnings of popular unrest were caused by increased Senate power, landlessness, and unemployment.

Increased Senate Power

Senate exercised great power during wars of the 3rd and 2nd centuries BCE

- Directed wars
- Controlled domestic & foreign policy
 - The advice of senate came to have the force of law – and the senate and magistrates controlled by a select circle of wealthy and powerful families

Land Hunger

- Punic Wars brought disastrous changes to farmers returning from military service:
 - Longer military terms of service – now a 6-year term (previously 2 years)
 - When returned from years of military service, many found their farms sold
 - A fine way to say thanks for their military service!
- Rise in Large Estates
 - After the 2nd Punic War - large areas of public land were available for purchase. Most of the land was cheaply bought or leased by wealthy patricians. Very little was then available for small peasant farmers.
 - Large estates primarily used slave labor – slaves were cheaper and plentiful after Rome's recent conquests
 - Also, slaves couldn't be recruited for military service – beneficial for the landowners

Unemployment

- Few opportunities for the landless to work as free laborers since most estates used slave labor. Slaves displaced roman citizens.
- Those who lost their land while serving in the military could not serve in the military again (since land ownership was a requirement). Where could they work now?

Newly landless families migrated to the cities as day laborers – this new class of urban workers was an unstable population.

The Gracchi Brothers

Social reformers were rare in Roman politics. The Gracchi brothers, of a noble family, attempted to tackle the social and economic problems of land hunger in the aftermath of the Punic Wars. Rome was suddenly rich and powerful, but also full of problems:

- Unemployed men on the streets who had lost their jobs to foreign slaves
- Farmers whose land was bought by wealthy aristocrats now had nothing to farm
- Rome's elected officials concentrated on what was best for themselves rather than for the common good
- The army had become unruly

Tiberius Gracchus (163-133 BCE)

- Family: Plebian; Gr. Grandfather held a consulship, Gr. Uncle held 2 consulships, Father held 2 consulships and received 2 triumphs, Mother was Cornelia – daughter of Scipio Africanus, Hannibal's conqueror
- Not a revolutionary – his proposals are essentially conservative
- Believed that the problems stemmed from the decline of the small farmer
- 133 BCE – elected tribune, campaigned on land reform
 - Proposed a land reform bill centered on land owned by the state
 - The law in force allowed a maximum purchase of 300 acres of public land, but many of the wealthy had acquired more
 - Tiberius proposed a law that required those who held more than the lawful 300 acres to surrender land above the legal threshold. The state would compensate them fairly. The new law would also allow landowners to keep an additional 150 acres of land for each son to farm. Tiberius wanted the unlawful, extra land surrendered and distributed among the poor in small lots of 17 acres, which would be protected from purchase by wealthier neighbors.
 - Wealthy landowners, many were senators, upset – they didn't want to lose profits from thousands of acres that they farmed virtually free.
 - Senate was upset –
 - Senate was alarmed about the principle behind the proposal – that the Republic play a role in balancing the distribution of wealth that both the rich and poor had created together.
 - The non-Roman upper class who rented the land would be adversely affected by the redistribution. Tiberius effectively proposed to take property used by Rome's allies without their consent or input.

- Senate refused to endorse the proposal, so Tiberius went directly to the *concilium plebis*, assembly of the plebs, who passed the bill.
 - Result: senatorial backlash. Octavius, a fellow tribune, vetoed the measure even before it came up for a vote.
 - Plutarch: “These tactics angered Tiberius. He then withdrew his conciliatory law and introduced one which was more gratifying to the people and harsher to the illegal owners of the land. It demanded that they should vacate the land which they acquired in defiance of the earlier laws, but this time with no compensation.”
- Octavius still planned to veto Tiberius’s proposal. An angry Tiberius decreed a ban on all public activity until a vote could be taken on the new law.
 - Mysteriously, on the day of the vote, all voting urns disappeared! Tiberius’s supporters were on the verge of rioting.
 - Senate was powerless to mediate. Tiberius suggested that the people vote on whether he and Octavius remain in office. Octavius refused. The following day the assembly stripped Octavius of his office. Octavius barely escaped an angry mob.
- Significance of Tiberius’s actions: Resentful of the obstacles thrown before his proposal, he fanned the flames of popular resentment against a small group of elites who blocked the state from responding to the needs of ordinary Romans.
 - Though not actively promoting violence – the threat of physical violence spread more fear than an actual riot could.
- Octavius out of the way – veto tabled – Tiberius’s reform passed.
 - Tiberius, Gaius (his brother), and Appian Claudius were chosen as commissioners to redistribute the public land.
- Senate’s action: refused to fund the land commission. Tiberius would need to come up with funding.
 - Fortuna prevailed! Attalus III, King of Pergamum (modern-day Bergama, Turkey), died, leaving his kingdom and treasury to the “Roman people.” Tiberius claimed the *concilium plebis* – NOT the Senate – should decide how to disperse the bequest.
 - Land reform moved forward. However, the land commission had a limited scope: it could redistribute land worked in parcels larger than 300 acres and only in certain parts of Italy.

Tiberius used the threat of strategically – at moments of political confrontation that made the situation even more volatile. He fanned the flames of public anger by encouraging rumors that political opponents threatened him. He didn’t order or condone violence, but he made regular use of its threat, also telling his followers that he feared “his enemies would break into his house at night and kill him.”

133 BCE: Trouble found Tiberius!

- Tiberius and 200-300 Romans were killed in a mob. Tiberius was clubbed to death. The Roman Republic irreversibly changed, “there was no longer a Republic but the rule of force and violence.”
- Cicero later wrote, “the death of Tiberius Gracchus, and even before his death, the whole manner of his tribunate divided one people into two factions.”
- Appian portrayed Tiberius both as “the first to die in civil strife” and as a figure whose death polarized the city between those who mourned him and those who were happy he died.
- Appian also noted that Tiberius “was killed on the capital while still tribune, because of a most excellent design he pursued violently.”

The Senate allowed the land reform to proceed. The Gracchan commission continued to work until about 118 BCE.

Gaius Gracchus (153-121 BCE)

- More of a reformer than Tiberius – a great orator with energy and charisma
- 123 & 122 BCE– elected tribune
 - Undertook ambitious legislation, paying for the proposals by revolutionizing the process of tax collection in the Asian province:
 - Pushed land reforms through senate: Reformed the process of land distribution, restarted the process of founding colonies for landless Romans
 - Gave equestrians (knight class; plebeian nobility) more rights:
 - Control over jury courts that tried provincial governors
 - Control over provincial taxation
 - Created a publicly funded grain distribution that sold grain @ below-market rates to all Roman citizens
 - Military: backed a law requiring the state to provide military equipment and clothing to soldiers at no cost. Set minimum age of recruitment to 17-year-olds.
- 121 BCE – Gaius failed to win reelection to his 3rd term. His legislation promoting full citizenship to all Latins and all Italians to assume the rights of Latins (trade and intermarriage with Romans) proved too progressive. A riot ensued - ~3,000 died, including Gaius.

Importance of Gracchus Brothers’ Reforms

The reforms of the Gracchus brothers were short-lived and did not have a significant impact on Rome. However, they showed the rise of the popular party in Rome. From this time on, politicians were divided between the optimates (mostly nobles who wanted to maintain oligarchic privilege) and the populares (aristocrats who used the popular assemblies to break the dominance of optimates).

Image of harmony shattered –

- The plebeian assembly emerged as an alternate power center.
- Equestrians (knights) gained a new sense of identity.
- Allies grew discontent as offers of citizenship were rescinded

The rise and fall of the Gracchus brothers were a watershed in Republican Rome's political history and set the stage for the rise of Marius, Sulla, Pompey, and Julius Caesar...

4/18-19

Roman Republic Crisis Slavery

Date	111-43 BCE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 35 (Caesar/Celts, Rubicon) OxR Ch 10, 8

Historian Mary Beard on the Roman 2nd and 1st centuries BCE:

“This was a period of expansion, political change, even revolution. There were vast Roman conquests overseas and, consequently, an enormous influx of wealth into the city. Gleaming marble from Greece, rather than local brick and stone, began to be used for temples and other public buildings in the city; slaves started to make up the majority of the workforce; and so many people flocked to Rome that its population topped a million, the only Western city of that size until London in the early 19th century.”

“But this age also saw repeated outbreaks of civil war at home, political disintegration, mass pogroms of citizens and the final fracture of what had once been a more or less democratic system of government.”

Despite the conflicts on the Roman home front, Rome continues to expand its borders:

- Across the Alps into Gaul
- Along the coast into Spain
- Inland up rivers (Rhine) making a new province of Transalpine Gaul
- Settlement of northern Africa

Marius - Defense of empire with the New Roman Army

A series of military disasters incurred anger against the old guard of the Senate. The disasters proved opportune for the rise of Marius. Marius, a “new man,” was a member of Roman equites whose ancestors had never been members of the Senate.

Sallust on Marius: possessed every attribute a consul needed “except for the antiquity of his family.”

- Jugurthine War - Marius came to prominence during the war in North Africa against Jugurtha and the Numidians
 - 111 BCE – Jugurtha seized the throne of Numidia (a client state of Rome). War against the usurper Jugurtha proceeded slowly
 - 107 BCE – Marius elected consul. Council of Plebs gave Marius command of an army in Africa-
 - This infringed on the senate's right to conduct war - Council of Plebs overrode the senate
 - Demonstrated that generals no longer needed to be loyal to the senate
 - Marius made a HUGE change in army procedures:
 - Called for volunteers (instead of going through routine conscription procedures)
 - Accepted landless men – many came from the Roman poor and hoped to gain substantial plunder
 - 105 BCE – Marius defeated Jugurtha. Marius proved to possess exceptional skill as a military commander. Jugurtha had been betrayed, taken captive by Marius's subordinate – a man from the family named **Sulla**.
- The defeat of the Germanic Cimbri and Teutones
 - (Were most probably German – but archaeologists find it challenging to confirm the distinctions between the Celtic Gallic and the Germanic tribes maintained in the Roman and Greek sources)
 - 113 BCE – the Cimbri and Teutones migrated from central Europe into Roman territory of southern Gaul (modern France), threatening to throw the Romans out and even march on Italy. Every Roman army they met was defeated.
 - 104 BCE – Romans happy with Marius. He was elected consul again in abstentia for a 2nd term (despite the law stating that 10 years needed to separate the consulships) and then another 4 consecutive terms, making a total of 6 consulships held.
 - He defeated the Cimbri & Teutones by 101 BCE – inflicting a massive defeat; tens of thousands were killed in battle while up to 60,000 were enslaved.

Legacy of Marius' army reforms

His precedent-setting recruitment from the landless urban citizens was a pivotal step leading to the collapse of the Republic –

- The landless recruits were promised land upon the conclusion of the campaign
- They swore an oath of loyalty to the general – not the senate/state

This new recruitment system placed much power in the hands of individual generals. The loyalty of legions allowed Marius, Sulla, and eventually Marius' nephew Julius Caesar to march on Rome itself.

Lead up to the civil wars-

Italian allies were growing angry at the way Romans treated them. As allies, they fought for Rome but were treated as 2nd class citizens. They were willing to serve in armies to defend Italy itself but resented being sent far to places like Spain. The Latins had also been ordered to leave Rome.

Tribune Marcus Livius Drusus proposed that citizenship be extended to all Italians. Extending citizenship angered many - Drusus was murdered. The dashed hopes of the allied Italians incited a revolt.

- Social War, or Italian War, or War of the Allies (90-88 BCE) ~‘social’ from *socii*, allies
 - 12 people groups joined to form the state of Italia; raised an army of 100,000
 - 1st year Rome was on the defensive. So, Rome offered citizenship to all allies who remained loyal to Rome.
 - Rome was able to defeat the remaining insurgents, but at a high price – the economy was disrupted, and the land was ravaged
 - Such destruction not seen since Hannibal’s occupation of Italy
- Peace came after 2 yrs of bitter fighting – the war ended when Rome granted full citizenship to all free Italians south of the Po River (basically the entire peninsula)

Rome’s armies are growing larger and larger. Army generals were becoming more powerful than the magistrates of the state, and the government could not do anything against the generals of the armies. For the next 50 years, there was a period of Civil War.

Marius and Sulla – just the beginning...

- War broke out in the East with Mithridates, king of Pontus. Sulla, a consul in 88 BC, was appointed by the Senate to command an army against Mithridates.
- Romans had controlled Asia for nearly half a century, and many Romans had commercial ties to the region. Tens of thousands of Romans had settled in Asia.
 - Mithridates ordered the massacre of as many as 80,000 Roman and Italian merchants, businessmen, colonists.
- Much of Asia fell out of Roman political control = serious financial implications. The loss of Asian tax revenue collapsed the Roman monetary system. Availability of credit dried up.
 - Asian tax revenue had financed the grain programs.
- Marius wanted the command. He and tribune Publius Sulpicius brought before the people a law appointing Marius general, overriding the Senate.
- Sulla took his army back to Rome – drove out Marius, killed Sulpicius, returned to the East
 - Momentous - **1st time Roman army marched on Rome to fight other Romans** – but not the last!
 - New Stage in the Republic:

- Sulla had shown that the armies of poor soldiers would choose loyalty to their commanders over allegiance to the Republic if the commander were sufficiently inspiring.
- Sulla showed that these armies could be made into personal weapons for individual commanders.
 - A lesson not lost on Sulla's rivals

Cinna, Sulla, and Dictatorship

- 87 BCE – Cinna, consul, tries to revive Sulpicius' proposals. The other consul opposes him. Cinna recruits Marius – they besiege Rome.
- 86 BCE – Cinna and Marius captured Rome, elected consuls, declared Sulla an outlaw, and killed many of Sulla's supporters. (Marius dies shortly thereafter).
- 84 BCE – Sulla successfully pushed Mithridates out of Greece sacked Athens and the Delphi treasury, allowing Sulla to distribute the booty among his officers and soldiers.
- 83 BCE – Sulla returned victorious from the East. He defeated armies opposing him in Italy; fought Romans and Samnites in Rome in 82 BCE. Sulla prevailed. He ordered the massacre of 6,000 Samnites in the Circus in Rome – times so that their cries rose up as Sulla addressed the Senate.
 - Forced state to name him dictator to "reconstitute the Republic"
 - Reign of terror against the opposition - Proscription list of 2,000-9,000 equestrians and senators, drawn up of those who could be killed for a reward. Their land was confiscated and distributed to Sulla's vets.
 - Needless to say, this caused quite an uproar
 - Enacted constitutional reforms (to restore power to the Senate), then retired
 - Senate enlarged to 600 (from 300); eliminated most powers of the popular assemblies and tribunes; restored senators to jury courts

78 BCE – Sulla died.

During these years, violence corroded the political system:

- Armies had fought in Rome
- The constitution was subverted by force
- Confiscations of land unsettled Italy
- Tribunes agitated for restoration of their power – clashed with consuls
- Widespread unrest fueled by rising corn prices

The structures of the old Republic could not support this new social and economic order birthed by violence. – *Edward Watts, historian*

Rise of Pompey

Senate made 2 military appointments:

- Crassus (112-53 BCE) – fought for Sulla, wealthy, put down slave revolt led by Spartacus
- Pompey (106-48 BCE) – fought for Sulla, given command in Spain in 77 BCE
 - Regains the Spanish provinces which were under revolt

70 BCE - Crassus and Pompey joined forces to become elected consuls

- They undid Sulla's reforms and restored power of the tribunes
 - Revived populares as a path to political power

Plebeian tribunes initiated legislation giving Pompey 2 critical commands:

- 67 BCE – cleared pirates from the Mediterranean Sea (in only 3 months rather than the expected 3 years)
- 66 BCE - Sent east to defeat Mithridates, who had begun a war against Rome once again. Pompey is victorious and ends the Seleucid monarchy, bringing Judea under Roman control. Reorganizes the east, adding 3 new provinces to Roman territory:
 - Cilicia
 - Syria
 - Bithynia et Pontus
 - Extraordinary achievement! The Stable eastern empire provided income from taxes and tribute, personal wealth, and political glory for himself – but the Senate was apprehensive about his power.

Pompey returned to Rome, expecting ratification of the reorganized East by the Senate and land for his vets – but was disappointed in this expectation

Marcus Tullius Cicero (106-43 BCE)

- Lawyer and gifted orator (trained in Athens)
- 1st in the family to get consulship
- He was brilliant and worked hard– in 75 BCE elected quaestor (assistant to the governor of Italy)
- Hated corruption – wanted to save the Roman Republic. He longed for the time when political leaders worked for the good of the state.

Cataline Conspiracy

- 63 BCE – Cicero elected consul
- Cicero opposed the populares; supported the optimates (aristocratic wealthy)
- Lucius Sergius Catalina, a populares supporter, had campaigned for consul based on cancellation of all debts (hoped Pompey's settlement in the East would pay for land for the landless poor)
 - Unsuccessful – talks of armed uprisings among his followers in Etruria
- Cicero denounced Catiline to his face in the Senate
 - Catiline fled to Etruria, where a rebellion had already begun

- Cicero discovered 5 conspirators in Rome. With Senate approval, he had them executed without trial. (His decision to execute Roman citizens without a trial would come to haunt him later).

62 BCE – Pompey returned disbanding his army. The Senate refused to ratify his settlement, and his vets remained landless. What now???

1st Triumvirate - Pompey, Julius Caesar and Crassus

Julius Caesar was a spokesman for the populares. He served as aedile and praetor before his military command in Spain.

- 60 BCE – Caesar returned from Spain. Seeks consulship, but many in Senate not supportive.
 - Caesar, Pompey, and Crassus all join together (triumvirs), agreeing “they would do things in common on behalf of each other.”
 - The three of them together could overcome the checks the Republic could place on their activities. A few decades later, Romans would see this as the beginning of the end of the Republic, but no one would have imagined that at the time.
- 59 BCE – Caesar elected consul – used popular assemblies to gain the aims of the triumvirs:
 - Pompey – got eastern settlement and land for his vets
 - Crassus – his supporters, received tax reductions on overbid contracts
 - Caesar – granted military command in Gaul for 5 years
- 56 BCE – the three renew their triumvirate. Crassus and Pompey elected consuls for 55 BCE to secure military commands for the year following consulship:
 - Caesar - 5 more years in Gaul
 - Crassus - command in Syria
 - Pompey – command in Spain

Cicero’s reaction to the Triumvirate

- Cicero shocked -Triumvirate controlled the Senate. Cicero refused to cooperate with the First Triumvirate. He was apprehensive about their growing power and outspoken about his opinions.
- Clodius (an enemy of Cicero) became a tribune in an election fixed by Caesar and Pompey. Clodius passed a law exiling anyone who condemned a citizen to death without trial
 - Cicero exiled to Macedon

End of Cicero’s Life

- When civil war erupted between Caesar and Pompey, Cicero had sided with Pompey. Caesar won – but pardoned Cicero; allowed him to return to Rome
- When Mark Antony ruled Rome, Cicero made speeches against Mark Antony. Antony was not thrilled – persuaded Octavian (Caesar's heir) to kill Cicero
 - Cicero's head and hands were cut off – displayed in the Forum
- Legacy –
 - A great orator and statesman
 - Writings survived – 900+ letters, as well as many speeches and essays
 - He loved the Roman Republic – even his enemies could appreciate his love for Rome

Slavery

“Here I, Lemiso, lie. Nothing but death ended my toil.” ~ epitaph from the grave of a slave

“All slavery is filled with bitterness: everyone locked in slavery at once does what he has to, but does it grumbling.” ~ Augustine

Slavery in the Ancient World

Slavery was omnipresent in antiquity – its existence was not questioned in any practical way. All of society believed the institution of slavery was an acceptable way of relating to other humans.

- Therefore, the story of slavery is one of accommodation to it or attempts to escape it. The idea of abolishing the institution was never considered.

Differences between Greco-Roman slavery and the New World slavery of North and South America:

- Race was not an element of slavery in antiquity
- A much wider diversity of slave life in antiquity

Sources of enslaved people

- Prisoners of war provided the greatest number of slaves
 - General Paulus (229-160 BCE) sold 150,000 captives taken in 70 towns in Greece
 - Marius (102-101 BCE) took 150,000 captives for slaves
 - Julius Caesar said to have captured ~500,000 Gauls in his 9 years of campaigning, selling them into slavery
- Pirates and bandits – steal people to sell on the slave market
- Children born to enslaved people
- Foundlings/abandoned infants
- Fathers could sell children into slavery – (but by 2nd century CE, this practice was forbidden)
- Criminals – given slavery as a punishment
- Legal self-enslavement (possible, but not many did this)

History of Slavery in Ancient Rome

Early Romans

- Result of debt
- Prisoners of war (also expected to be enslaved if captured) but the numbers were small

Punic War

- Until Rome went to war with Carthage, she was relatively poor. The Punic Wars made her rich. Overnight, Rome became the heart of the Mediterranean trade. The chief commodity: slaves.
 - Result - Huge increase in slavery from the Punic Wars. In turn, the increased use of slaves displaced many free workers, creating high unemployment (as well as dissatisfaction among the poor).

Piracy

- Piracy familiar to Greeks as a steady trade for slaves
- Piracy swelled into big business in the eastern Mediterranean ~150 BCE. Many people were abducted and sold as slaves on the auction block. When piracy threatened famine and affected Rome's finances too much, the Senate sent General Pompey to rid the Mediterranean of pirates in 63 BCE. He was successful– the Mediterranean remained free of pirates for quite a while afterwards.

Peacetime – Imperial Rome

- # of slaves peaked in Early Empire. After the reign of Augustus, the expansion of the empire considerably slowed. Roman policies became more defensive.
 - Defensive policies led to a decrease in slaves from foreign conquest.
 - Piracy was also under control.
 - Therefore - Most slaves now came from children born to slave mothers
 - Slaves were bred for sale

Slavery was most prevalent in Italy – slaves were used much less in western parts of the empire.

Life of a Slave

Total subjection of slave to the master – there were kind masters, but the harsh treatment of slaves by the masters was generally the norm. Physical abuse was the most frequent and violent form of exploitation. Sexual abuse was perhaps the worst combination of physical and psychological abuse.

- “Female slaves are forced unwillingly to service their most shameless masters; these sate their lust on them, trapped as they are by their condition, unable to resist” ~ Salvian, 5th century CE
- Male slaves were also subject to sexual abuse

Urban enslaved people’s conditions were generally better than the rural slaves who worked on large ranches or mines. Those on ranches and in mines worked under harsh conditions, in chains, and under the lash – resulting in shortened lifespans. Because of the surfeit of slaves, they were easily replaced.

Despite slavery, men and women could experience a sense of their dignity and worth. A slave’s identity was a combination of what was imposed on him and what he could fashion for himself.

- A slave’s occupation was essential to the formation and maintenance of identity. In work, the slave could establish identity. Doing a job well satisfied the master and could also earn rewards for the slave. Many slaves focused on this area of their lives in which they had some control.
 - The epigraphy of slaves mentions occupation much more than freepersons do, indicative of their pride in their job skills.

Slaves could also participate in clubs or mutual aid societies licensed by the state. They were usually religious and served the functions of a craft guild, social club, and funeral society. The societies provided a refuge for slaves and a sense of community or brotherhood.

Various Occupations of Slaves

- Crafts and Trades – potters, metal workers, artists

- Often fared better than some other slaves (miners, plantation workers)
- Household/domestic slaves – servants, cooks, tutors, hairdressers, handicrafts
 - Usually better fed and clothed
- Entertainers – musicians, actors, singers
- Imperial slaves – served in the emperor’s household
- Public slaves – clerks, secretaries, built canals, aqueducts
- Prostitution – but Emperor Vespasian stopped the selling of slaves for prostitution
- Mines and quarries– horrible conditions, short lifespan
 - “The shafts are not cut in a straight line but follow the veins of the shining stone. Where the daylight is shut out by the twists and turns of the quarry, they wear lamps tied to their foreheads, and there, contorting their bodies to the contours of the rock, they throw their quarried fragments to the ground, toiling on and on without intermission under the pitiless overseer’s lash.” ~ historian Diodorus, 1st century BCE
- Large ranch/plantation slaves - worked in a chain-gang system on many estates, from dawn to dusk, subject to pitiless treatment

Manumission

- Difference between Greece and Rome
 - Emancipation occurred more often in ancient Rome than in ancient Greece
 - Rome differed from Greece in that freed slaves became full Roman citizens, as well as their descendants
 - In 56 CE, a senator noted that “most of the knights and many of the senators are descendants of slaves.”
 - Emperor Diocletian was born into slavery in Dalmatia – won power through military skill
- Manumission controlled by the masters – enslaved people in urban households more likely to be emancipated than those in the countryside
 - Customary for the freed slave to remain attached to his former owner – owner became a patron
- Imperial Freedmen
 - The imperial government began using many freedmen, the numbers significantly increasing with Emperor Claudius, as imperial bureaucracy grew

Slave Revolts

Revolts were not frequent – required planning, organization, discipline, and leadership – but Romans feared the possibility of a slave revolt

- Conditions for revolts
 - The heavily male slave population in an area
 - Recently imported into slavery
 - More numerous than the free population

- Cruel treatment
- Largest revolts
 - Sicily
 - Known for some of the worst conditions of slavery
 - 2 large revolts: 135-132 BCE and 104-100 BCE
 - The Roman army put both down
 - Spartacus
 - 73 BCE – led a slave revolt at a gladiator school in Capua
 - A Thracian noble who had served in the Roman legions – he had deserted, was captured, and then sold into slavery. Bought by the gladiator training school in Capua
 - He and 70 other gladiators broke for freedom
 - Spartacus mobilized tens of thousands of slaves from gladiatorial training schools, farms, plantations in the peninsula's south.
 - Free Italians left their fields to join Spartacus (a result of Sulla's land confiscations hitting free Italians harshly)
 - His followers had nothing to lose – they would die fighting the Romans or be executed by Romans if they surrendered. They fought with a ferocity the Roman levies sent to confront them could not match.
 - The Roman army sent to capture them, but Spartacus outmaneuvers the Romans
 - Senate sends Crassus with 8 legions – but Spartacus still escapes!
 - Senate then sent Pompey with his army to join with Crassus. Eventually, the Roman army defeated them. Crassus killed Spartacus. Pompey returned to Rome as the most powerful man in the Republic
 - 6,000 rebels were crucified – hung along the Appian Way, the main road leading to Rome

A Lone Voice Against Slavery in Antiquity

Bishop Gregory of Nyssa on Slavery

c. 335-395 CE

“I got me slaves and slave-girls,
And homebred slaves were born for me,
And much property in cattle and sheep became mine.”

Gregory of Nyssa has much to say regarding the above quote.

"I got me slaves and slave-girls." You are condemning to slavery human beings whose nature is free and characterized by free will. You are making laws that rival the law of God, overturning the law appropriate for humankind. Human beings were created specifically to have dominion over earth; it was determined by their creator that they should exercise authority. Yet you place them under the yoke of slavery, as though you are opposing and fighting against the divine decree.

Tell me what sort of price you paid...For how many obols did you value the image of God? For how many coins did you sell this nature formed by God? God said: "Let us make human beings in our own image and likeness" (Gen 1:26). When we are talking about one who is in the image of God, who has dominion over the whole earth and who has been granted by God authority over everything on the earth, tell me, who is the seller and who is the buyer?...If God does not enslave a free person, then who would consider their own authority higher than Gods?

So when you are equivalent in every way, tell me in what particular way you have more so that you think you can become master of another human being even though you are a human being yourself. "I got me," you say, "slaves and slave-girls," as though they were a herd of goats or swine. After saying "I got me slaves and slave-girls," he added the good cheer that comes through flocks and herds. For he says "And much property in cattle and sheep became mine," as though animals and slaves were subject to his authority to an equal degree.

(Text taken from the Early Church Texts website, translated by Reverend Andrew Maguire)

4/20-21

Roman Republic Julius Caesar

Date	100-44 BCE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 35 (Cleopatra) OxR Ch 11

“The Age of Caesar, then, was one of political murder, street violence, constant warfare both inside and outside Rome and fundamental disagreements about how the state should be run, how democracy and liberty might be preserved, while the demands of empire and security were met.”

~Mary Beard, historian

A Dangerous Reality

The Republic could now only function when superintended by the most powerful man in Rome – and only with military backing.

Middle of the 50s BCE: Tribune Gaius Curio called for Pompey and Caesar to dismiss their armies simultaneously. Caesar welcomed the measure (he and Pompey would then be on similar footing), but Pompey refused.

50 BCE: Last senate meeting showed the Republic had no means to stop the personal conflict between Caesar and Pompey. A vote by the Senate for the armies of both men to be dismissed was endorsed by a 370-22 vote. The Senate and the Roman populace desired this, but the Republic was too weak to prevent the 2 leaders from marching into civil war.

The republican system no longer constrained the individual.

Gaius Julius Caesar (c. 100-44 BCE)

- From the patrician Julii Caesares family
- Associated himself with the populares causes; spent lavishly/beyond his resources to win the favor of the poor by giving them feasts and entertainments
- Talented, a fine speaker, generally magnanimous to those he defeated
- Very ambitious, many saw him as a flawed genius – prone to sudden rash acts
- Caesar’s personality enabled him to build enduring friendships with his peers and bring together the bitterest rivals.

Caesar Crossing the Rubicon

Caesar had gone into Gaul debt-ridden 10 years earlier, but the profits from his campaigns made him one of the wealthiest men in the Republic – even after repayment of all his debts.

Both Caesar and Pompey were powerful – the Senate was wary of both but believed that Pompey was less harmful to their cause. They ordered Caesar to lay down command and return as a private citizen.

- However, the optimates in the Senate despised Caesar and his conquests – wanted to prosecute him for many reasons, including conducting an illegal war into Germania that the Senate never authorized. Caesar's options were:
 - surrender and face prosecution
 - go to war
- Caesar tried to compromise with the Senate, but they were immovable. On January 1, 49 BC, the Senate declared Caesar, a public enemy of Rome. Pompey was in charge of the defense of Rome.

Caesar likely arrived at Cisalpine Gaul's frontier border on the Rubicon River around January 11. Contemplating before making his final fateful decision, Plutarch writes that he then shouted, "Alea iacta est!" ("Let the die be cast" or "let the game be ventured"; most likely spoke the words in Greek, quoting Menander, about a situation where the throw's result is not yet known) as he led his men across the Rubicon. Caesar invaded the legal border from his province into Italy, starting the civil war. (The phrase "crossing the Rubicon" is still used today as a metaphor for proceeding past a point of no return).

The Civil War (49-46 BCE)

Caesar had to move quickly before Pompey's legions could be mobilized from Spain.

- Caesar found little opposition in marching south to Rome
 - Pompey was horrified to find no uprising in his favor. The people had little trust in the Senate; Caesar had won them over through his popular agenda while in office.
 - March 49 BCE – lacking support and unable to raise an army, Pompey and the Senate left Italy. They traveled to Greece with the consuls of 49 BCE and most of the Senate.
 - Pompey abandoned Rome quickly, leaving Caesar both the world's largest city and the public treasury.
 - Caesar reassured the Romans he would not do as Sulla and Marius had
 - Ahenobarbus, the governor sent by Pompey to take over Caesar's Gallic command, was captured by Caesar but quickly released without harm. These actions reinforced Caesar's claim that he wasn't a tyrant but benevolent. Pompey, Cato, and the senatorial faction had wronged Rome.
- Spain – Caesar eliminated Pompey's armies in Spain, then subdued Sicily and Sardinia
- Pharsalus, northern Greece – Caesar meets Pompey in battle. Despite being outnumbered, Caesar defeats Pompey's army. Pompey flees to Egypt

- Egypt – Caesar follows Pompey to Egypt. Pompey was murdered on orders of Egyptian authorities, and his head was presented to Caesar. Caesar wept – he didn't like seeing Pompey beheaded. Pompey was his son-in-law and former friend.
 - Caesar spends 7 months in Egypt.
 - Ptolemy XII and his sister Cleopatra ruled Egypt. Cleopatra wanted to have sole power – went to Syria to raise troops. When Caesar installed himself in the palace at Alexandria, Cleopatra smuggled herself into the palace in a rug to speak with Caesar. In short order, she was Caesar's mistress. Caesar, with his troops and her Syrian troops, defeats Ptolemy. Cleopatra becomes the sole ruler.
- Pontus, 47 BCE - Caesar defeats Mithridates' son, king of Pontus, while returning to Italy. Pompey's Adriatic fleet is eliminated. In recognition of his overwhelming victory, Caesar sent a message back to Rome and the Senate: "VENI VEDI VICI." I CAME, I SAW, I CONQUERED.
- Africa, 46 BCE – Caesar defeats Pompey's supporters and the old senatorial order. Caesar returns to Rome, holds 4 triumphs, then needs to go to Spain for what will be his final military campaign.
- Spain. Caesar defeats Pompey's son in a hard-won battle in 45 BCE. He returns triumphantly to Rome.

Finis – the old order is dead

Caesar as Dictator

Caesar returned to Rome. He had been made dictator in 46 BCE for a 10-year term, but in 44 BCE, he was made dictator for life.

Caesar did make reforms – tried to address some social problems:

- Pardoned citizens who had taken up arms against him in the civil war
- Provincial taxes collected directly instead of through the hated and corrupt tax-farmers
- Forced large farmers to hire at least 1/3 of their labor from free citizens rather than slaves, ensuring work for the landless poor
- Set up new colonies of Roman citizens in North Africa, Spain, and Gaul
- Citizenship granted to loyal provincial communities
- Replaced the Roman lunar calendar with a calendar based on the solar year.
- Commissioned great public works: courthouses, marketplaces, library, Curia Julia

But the crucial problem of Caesar's position was not yet solved. He seemed to become increasingly absolutist – opposition began to grow against Caesar. He had the aura of a Hellenistic monarch (gilded chair, triumphal purple robe for public appearances). Imperator became a legal

title that he could use. The Senate had agreed that Caesar could wear a crown while campaigning against Parthia. People, especially senators and aristocrats, feared Caesar becoming a king.

Ides of March

A conspiracy against Caesar likely festered for a long time. Still, it became a legitimate threat when senators discovered that Caesar planned to leave Rome on a campaign to Parthia on March 18. He would be gone on campaign for quite a while, so it was now or never

- A group of 60 senators – committed Republicans (Cassius and Brutus), former supporters of Pompey, and others with personal resentments – conspired and kept secret the assassination plans. They planned to execute it on March 15, 3 days before his expected departure for Parthia.
- According to Suetonius and Plutarch, a soothsayer named Spurinna was said to have warned Caesar, “Beware the Ides of March.”

Death of Caesar

His wife Calpurnia had begged Caesar to stay home on the morning of March 15. Ancient writers record that she had nightmares warning her of impending danger. Caesar decided to heed her reservations and sent word to Antony to dismiss the Senate.

Decimus Brutus, Caesar’s close friend, was sent to Caesar to persuade him to come. Despite his wife’s pleas, Brutus was successful in his quest – Caesar left to attend the meeting. The meeting with the Senate was at Pompey’s theater. Caesar sat down to receive petitions from the senators, as was customary. Except that this time, 60 senators were bearing down upon him. Each conspirator was armed with a dagger, and at the signal (Cimber grabbing Caesar’s robe from his shoulders), each one stabbed Caesar.

- Shakespeare’s “Et tu Brute?” makes for good drama, but ancient sources suggest Caesar said nothing.
- Plutarch’s account records that Caesar pulled his toga over his head and took 23 dagger blows.
- Ironically, Caesar collapsed at the foot of Pompey’s statue, Pompey, who led Romans against Caesar’s growing power.

Aftermath-

Conspirators took refuge on Capitoline Hill – crowds didn’t support the conspirators
Made compromise with surviving consul and supporters of Caesar:

- Dictatorship abolished
- Amnesty to the murderers
- All Caesar’s acts confirmed
- No prosecution for activities during the civil war

When the populace found out that Caesar had left his gardens to the city and \$ for each citizen – the fury against the murderers forced Brutus and Cassius to leave Rome

Political Fallout

Antony – with the support of Lepidus, Caesar's Master of the Horse, held the initiative

- Secured a command in Gaul
- Recruited 6,000 former centurions to serve as his bodyguards

Octavian – 19 years old, Caesar's heir

- Claimed his inheritance – recruited troops

Octavian defeated Antony's troops in Gaul. Both consuls were killed. Octavian took his 8 legions to Rome and met with Antony and Lepidus

- Set up a triumvirate – the 2nd Triumvirate
 - Not a secret pact, like the 1st Triumvirate that left the Republican system largely intact – but a legal arrangement that was essentially a joint dictatorship
- Divided the west between them
- Made laws and appointed magistrates

Riddance of Enemies

The three decided to rid themselves of Caesar's and their enemies

- Needed land in Italy to settle their armies
- A death list was drawn up of 300 senators, 2,000 equestrians, and Cicero

Lepidus was left in Italy while Antony and Octavian went east after Brutus and Cassius

- Armies of Brutus and Cassius were defeated at Philippi in Greece by Antony
- Brutus and Cassius commit suicide

Now there is a new division of the empire-

- Octavian – west up to Illyrium
- Antony – Macedonia and eastward
- Lepidus – Africa
 - 36 BCE – Lepidus unwisely challenged Octavian. His troops deserted him, so he was forced to surrender to Octavian. Octavian let him live his remaining years in Africa.

Years of unrest and war followed, ultimately leading to the end of the Republic.

The End of the Republic

*For the end, Janus,
Is a beginning, and a dark lies beyond the door.*

Stuart Laycock

4/25-28

Roman Empire Cleopatra and Augustus

Date	43 BCE - CE 14 31 BCE - CE 14 “Age of Augustus”
Themes	Trade and Commerce Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	4/25-26 SOTW Ch 35 (Death of Caesar) OxR Ch 12 4/27-28 SOTW Ch 36 OxR Ch 13

Cleopatra and Mark Antony

42 BCE - Antony called Cleopatra to Tarsus to question her about any role she may have played in assisting his enemies in the aftermath of Caesar’s assassination. He became quite smitten - spent the winter with Cleopatra in Alexandria. After Antony returned to Rome, Cleopatra gave birth to twins: Alexander Helios (sun) and Cleopatra Selene (moon).

Rome’s disillusionment with Antony

Antony marries Octavian’s half-sister Octavia, attempting to cement his alliance with Octavian. However, while married to Octavia, Cleopatra bears another son to Antony in 36 BCE. Antony and Cleopatra marry before his divorce from Octavia. Antony seemed to take on eastern culture: dressing as an Egyptian and practicing eastern customs.

- Donations of Alexandria
 - 34 BCE - In a public celebration, Antony declared Caesarion as Caesar’s rightful heir (instead of Octavian) and made each of their children regent of various eastern provinces. Cleopatra was proclaimed Queen of Queens and Caesarion King of Kings. Many people became wary.
 - A propaganda war began between Octavian and Antony. Octavian claimed that Antony was under the control of Cleopatra and that he would abandon Rome to establish a new capital in Egypt.

32 BCE – Senate stripped Antony of his titles. Octavian declared war on Cleopatra.

Actium, 31 BC
Octavian proud
Antony and lover prowed,
Dreams of power rammed.
Stuart Laycock

Final Struggle of the Republic

31 BCE – Battle of Actium

- They met at Actium, a cape on the western coast of northern Greece
- Antony's fleet was trapped. He tried to break out with his fleet but was unsuccessful.
- Antony and Cleopatra fled to Egypt. Octavian took the surrender of the army and navy.

30 BCE – Death of Antony and Cleopatra

- A year after Actium, Octavian arrives in Alexandria
 - Antony's cavalry and navy refused to fight Octavian – they joined him instead, as did the infantry shortly after.
 - Antony falls on his sword, committing suicide in the Roman tradition.
- About a week later, Cleopatra also ends her life. According to Plutarch, she allowed a poisonous asp to bite her.
 - Octavian has Caesarion killed.
 - Caesarion's half-sister Cleopatra Selene is spared, brought to Rome. Octavian provided for her and arranged her marriage to King Juba II, King of Numidia, in 20 BCE.

Egypt, the last of the great Hellenistic kingdoms, is now a Roman province.

Augustus and the Founding of the Empire

Since the Social War of 90 BCE, there had been periods of disruption in Italy; the years 49-31 BCE comprised almost continuous civil war. Octavian appeared to be able to offer peace. In the years that followed, he was able to forge a permanent settlement with the senators that transformed the republic's collapse into an empire, all the while maintaining the pretense that republican ideals persisted.

"Restoration of the Republic"

When he arrived back in Rome, Octavian focused on dispelling fears that he was to be a military dictator.

- Disbanded 100,000 men and settled them on land he paid for from his funds

January 27, 28 BCE – Octavian declares it was now safe to restore the Republic

- He would surrender all his powers to the Senate
 - His surrender was politically astute – senators and Octavian knew that order could not be kept without him, so an elaborate charade of maintaining republican traditions was played out
- Senate transferred power back into Octavian's hands "temporarily":
 - Octavian was offered administration of provinces of Gaul, Spain, Cyprus, Cilicia, and Syria (where most of the legions were stationed = effectively confirmed his role as supreme military commander)
 - Senate conferred the title "Augustus" – "the revered one."
 - Although Octavian himself preferred princeps (chief citizen or first among equals)
 - Early Empire became known as a Principate (until Diocletian preferred Dominus, 'lord' or 'master' to princeps)
 - Octavian remained consul; renewed each year until 23 BCE. He surrendered the consulship but was given 'greater proconsular power.'
 - Granted full tribunician powers in 23 BCE (the guardian of the people's rights)
- Senate retained authority to govern the provinces without military significance, elect magistrates and administer various traditional powers

Augustus was very popular

- Ending the civil wars made people happy
- Control of the army made peace possible
- Peace brought prosperity
- Given the title 'Pater Patriae,' 'Father of the Fatherland.'

Army

Augustus established a professional army, loyal to the state and with formal conditions of service and arrangements for discharge. The peace of the empire and the security of the princeps were dependent upon the army.

Role of the Army

- Guard frontiers
- Maintain order within the provinces
- Agent for upward mobility for officers and recruits
- Romanization occurred wherever the army was stationed
- Colonies of veterans helped Romanize the provinces

Standing army

- Maintained 28 legions
 - Legion=5,400 soldiers (+non-combatants=6,000 men/legion)
 - ~150,000 total men in army – small by modern standards (population of empire about 50 million)
- Legionaries served 20 years
- Recruited from citizenry (under Augustus, from Italian citizens)

Auxillary forces – (from non-citizens in the provinces)

- Served as light-armed troops, cavalry
 - Under Augustus, ~130,000 recruited
- Served for 24 years, after which they and their families received full citizenship)

Praetorian Guard

- For guarding the person of the princeps – the emperor's guard
- 9 cohorts of 6 centuries (~5,400 men) were recruited from Italian citizens
- Crucial during instable times

Augusta's Frontier policy

- East – bounded by client kingdoms
 - Augustus didn't create new provinces there – he wanted to minimize the need for army presence there so that his armies could be used elsewhere
- West –
 - Final pacification of Spain
 - Gallic conquests consolidated into 3 provinces
- North –
 - Central and maritime Alps conquered
 - Roman control expanded from the Balkan peninsula up to the Danube
 - Tried to expand into Germany, but massive defeats led Rome to consider the Rhine River as the border between Gaul and German tribes to the east
 - Losses taught Augustus that Roman power was limited

Reforms

Religion

Augustus believed civil strife in the 1st century BCE was caused by the decline in participation in public religion, so...

- Restored traditional priesthood, rebuilt temples, and built new temples
- Initiated new cult – the Imperial cult
- Believed it would be unifying

Morals

Augusta believed the decline in Roman morals was detrimental to the empire

- Created legislation to arrest the decline in morals
 - Limits on feast expenditures
 - Adultery is a criminal offense
 - Tax law to penalize bachelors, widowers, and married with less than 3 kids

Building/Restoration Plan

During years of strife, Rome fell into decay – implemented a building/restoration plan

- Rebuilt Rome – buildings, statues, decorations
- Repaired roads, bridges
- Set up guard posts along main routes
- Encouraged building or reconstruction of towns

Death of Augustus

Augustus died in 14 CE. There was no imperial constitutional, so theoretically, the Republic could have been revived at his death. However, during the 45 years since Augustus' defeat of Mark Antony, the principate had become too entrenched for the republic to be restored. In true monarchical fashion, Augustus designated an heir to succeed him – his stepson Tiberius.

Legacy

Augustus had created a new political system that brought peace and stability to the empire. This stability was achieved at the expense of the old republican liberties, the traditional powers of the senate and the assemblies, and the direction of noble families of government through the magistracies. The risk was that the new system would degenerate into tyranny, and it did in several reigns that followed. Yet no alternative form of government ever emerged in the Roman Empire, and the emperors stretched into an almost unbroken line to the final overthrow of Constantinople in 1453 CE. The longevity of the empire is the measure of Augustus' achievement.

5/2-5

World Religion Study Christianity

Date c. 4 BCE – c. CE 400

Themes Philosophy and Religions

Readings 4/30-5/1 SOTW Ch 37 (Birth of Jesus)
WR p48-55; OxR Ch 24 pp. 155-160
5/2-5/3 SOTW Ch 37 (Death of Jesus)
WR p 56-63

The advent of Christianity marks a fundamental break with the dominant values of the Greco-Roman world

- Christians viewed God, humans, and the world quite differently than the Greeks and the Romans
- Christianity had a significant impact on Western Civilization when it became the Roman state religion

Jewish Background – World in Which Jesus Lived

During Hellenistic times, the Jews were fairly independent under Seleucid rulers. But that changed with Roman involvement-

- 63 BC – Pompey entered Jerusalem. The Herodian Kingdom was established as a client king of Rome.
 - Senate gave Herod the Great the title “King of the Jews” in 40 BC. When he died in 4 BC, his kingdom was divided among his sons, who became tetrarchs.
- 6 AD – Judaea became a Roman province, governed by a Roman prefect (governor)
 - Judaea didn’t include Galilee – Galilee was ruled by Roman client king Herod Antipas (r. 4 BC-AD 39), tetrarch of Galilee, and Perea
 - The Jewish people detested the Herodian family for its authoritarian rule and the selling out of Jewish heritage to a foreign power.

A Tense World

There was unrest between Romans and Jews and among the Jews themselves. The religious climate was turbulent, with 4 distinct movements within Judaism:

- Pharisees –
 - devout, legalistic, rigid adherence to Jewish ritual, didn’t want to cooperate with Rome, wanted free of Romans (without violence), believed in resurrection after death, believed Moses gave an oral Torah as well as a written Torah, that was handed down from teachers (rabbis) to students
- Sadducees –

- wealthy/aristocratic, sought to conserve their wealth and power through cooperation with Rome, controlled the hereditary Temple priesthood, did not believe in resurrection after death, claimed right to interpret written Torah (rejected Oral Torah)
- Essenes –
 - extreme in their observance of the Torah but isolated themselves by the Dead Sea, awaiting the Messiah
- Zealots –
 - theologically agreed with the Pharisees but preached a violent overthrow of Roman rule, revolutionary/militant extremists

Origins of Christianity

Jesus of Nazareth (c. 6 BCE-CE 30)

- Palestinian Jew raised in Galilee, in the village of Nazareth
 - Client kings governed Galilee. Herod the Great was king at Jesus' birth.
- Jesus began itinerant preaching
 - Presented ethical concepts (humility, charity, brotherly love) that would form the basis of the value system of medieval Western Civilization – not the value systems of classical Greco-Roman civilization
- Jesus was denounced on many sides:
 - Jesus spoke of a heavenly kingdom – radicals were disappointed
 - Conservative religious leaders believed him a false Messiah, which would undermine traditional Jewish religion
 - Roman authorities believed him a potential revolutionary – might use the Jewish expectation of a messianic kingdom to incite a revolt against Rome
- Crucifixion of Jesus
 - Tense time – Pontius Pilate, governor (prefect) of Judaea. Jews angered by his insensitivity
 - Caiaphas, the chief priest in Jerusalem, was put in charge by the Romans but feared Roman retaliation if he didn't handle local unrest well
 - Passover - Most sensitive time of the year in Jerusalem– thousands of Jews came to Jerusalem to attend. The governor also came to oversee the event, ensuring good order.
 - When Jesus entered Jerusalem at Passover, he was entering a volatile situation
 - Jesus was arrested and taken to Caiaphas. Accused of blasphemy when he refused to deny his divinity, Jesus was taken to the Sanhedrin (highest council of Jews). Sanhedrin wanted him executed, but Roman approval was needed for that. Brought before prefect Pontius Pilate, Pilate eventually condemned Jesus to crucifixion.
- Christians believe that 3 days after his death, he was resurrected – that he came back to life. Belief in the resurrection became a central doctrine of Christian belief.

Early Christian Community

Christianity began as a religious movement within Judaism

- Converts were mainly Greek-speaking Jews. Small congregations cropped up within Jewish communities of large cities such as Damascus, Antioch
- The synagogues in these communities attracted Gentiles (non-Jews)
- Met in homes
- Loosely organized communities – men and women held significant roles
- Church under the leadership of boards of elders (presbyters)
 - Beginning in the 2nd century – bishops began to exercise authority over presbyters

Paul of Tarsus

- A Hellenistic Jew (a Greek-speaking Pharisee) from Tarsus in Cilicia and a Roman citizen
- He initially persecuted Christians, but then experienced a vision of Jesus – became a Christian believer
- Believed that the message of Jesus also applied to Gentiles
- Emphasized faith rather than rigid adherence to Jewish law
- Founded Christian communities throughout Asia Minor and along the Aegean coast
- Provided a foundation for the spread of Christianity
- Killed by the Romans

Spread of Christianity

- Initially spread slowly...
- By 100 AD – churches were established in most major eastern cities and some in the west
 - Many early Christians converts were Hellenized Jews and from Greek-speaking populations
- 2nd and 3rd centuries – more Latin speaking people converted (facilitated by the translation of the Greek New Testament into Latin)
- The structure of Roman society aided growth – the spread of the Christian faith aided by the well-built, efficient Roman roads that traversed the empire
- Higher class Romans gravitated to Christianity due to similarities with Stoicism
- Slave trade may have played a large part in the transmission of the faith – slaves and the poorer members of society were particularly drawn to Christianity. Critics accused Christians of being able to convince only “slaves, women and children.”

Christianity Within the Spiritual Life of the Empire

Quite an array of religions existed in Imperial Rome:

- Traditional Roman religion with an emphasis on rituals/ceremonies precisely performed
- Imperial Cult – worship of the emperors as gods
- Temples, oracles, shrines survived alongside the official state religion
- Judaism
- Celtic water and river gods
- Egyptian animal worship persisted
- Mystery cults from the east: Cult of Isis, Cult of Cybele, Mithraism
 - Appealed to those who sought a more personal religious experience
 - The gods and goddesses tended to come from outside the Greek world
 - A deity was elevated to supreme deity (but no deity was claimed the only deity)
- Early Christians were seen as both in the world of mystery cults and outside it
 - There were some similarities in imagery, but also significant differences:
 - Christianity rejected all other gods
 - Christians were persecuted for not worshipping the recognized gods (Christians were called atheists) and claiming Jesus a king, which went against the Roman state.

Roman View of Christianity

As Christianity grew and spread – the Roman attitude began to change

- Romans were very tolerant of religions until they threatened public order or morals
- Saw Christians as harmful to the state
- Christians abstained from public festivals of Roman deities
- Refused to worship state gods and imperial cult – seen as treason, punishable by death

Appeal of Christianity

By the 3rd century, Christianity was spreading widely – WHY?

Historians offer several reasons:

- The message of salvation appealing in a world full of suffering and injustice
- Not unfamiliar-
 - It could be seen as another eastern mystery cult
- Had universal appeal
- Not restricted to men (like Mithraism)
- No initiation rites
- Gave new meaning to life
- Offered what the Roman state religion could not – a relationship with God and link with higher worlds
- Fulfilled a human need to belong – Christians formed communities
- Attractive to all classes

Emperor Constantine, Theodosius, and Christianity in the Empire

Licinius and Constantine issued the Edict of Milan in 313 AD – it permitted the practice of all religions, including Christianity. Christianity was now tolerated; the Roman state also spent money on churches. State support of churches helped the spread of Christianity.

Emperor Theodosius I (r. 379-395) made Nicene Trinitarian Christianity the official state religion; non-Nicene Creed Christians were considered heretics and persecuted for following a forbidden religion. Paganism was forbidden; pagans were persecuted, and pagan temples were closed. No other religion was tolerated. As the 5th century dawned, Christians made up most of the population. Theodosius II (r. 408-450) introduced anti-Jewish measures.

Beginnings of World Religion

Christianity

Origins:

Christians believe in one God. The central figure in Christianity is Jesus (or Christ), a Jew who came into this world by the immaculate conception of the virgin Mary. Jesus was born in Roman-occupied Judea c. 4 BC.

Significance:

Once the Roman Emperor Constantine converted to Christianity (in 313 AD) and made Christianity a legal religion, the Christian faith spread quickly throughout the Roman Empire. In 391 CE, Christianity became the official religion of the Roman Empire and had a significant impact on the development of western civilizations.

Central figure(s):

Jesus, Mary – mother of Jesus, John the Baptist, Apostle Paul, Peter

Sources:

The Holy Scriptures for Christianity are the Bible, consisting of the Old Testament (the Jewish Bible, sacred to Judaism and Islam) and the New Testament. The Old Testament chronicles the lives of Jews and others who lived before Jesus, who God had promised a savior and was waiting for him. It contains the Books of Moses, major and minor prophets, histories, poems, songs, and proverbs.

The New Testament is unique to Christianity, for it centers around the figure of Jesus and his effect upon the world. Christians believe that Jesus was the Messiah that the Old Testament foretold, so instead of looking for a savior, they await the return of Jesus. The New Testament contains the Gospels, Acts of the Apostles, epistles (letters), and the Book of Revelations.

Central beliefs

Following are the fundamental beliefs of Christianity. (Variations may exist among the different sects of Christianity):

- Christians believe there is only one God.
- The Bible is the final revelation of God. The Bible consists of The Old Testament (books written before Jesus) and The New Testament (books about Jesus and how, through Jesus, God could enter into a relationship with all people).
- Belief in the Trinity: God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit existing as one entity.
- Death and Resurrection of Jesus: Jesus was crucified on the cross. Christians believe that Jesus died for people's sins and was resurrected from the dead 3 days later.
- Return of Jesus: Bible proclaims that Jesus will return.
- Salvation: Christians believe in life after death. Those who believe in Jesus will be forgiven, saved, and live with God eternally, whereas unbelievers will be separated from God and punished.

Current number practicing and geographical areas:

As of 2019, there are about 2.5 billion Christians worldwide, or 31% of the world's population, according to the Center for the Study of Global Christianity.

5/9-10

Roman Empire Successors of Augustus

Date	14-96 CE
Themes	Trade and Commerce Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	SOTW Ch 39 Nero, Christians in Catacombs OxR Ch 14

Roman Empire at the death of Augustus extended from Portugal to Syria; the English Channel to Egypt.

Augustus' Successors: Misery, Mistrust, Murder

Julio-Claudian Dynasty -

Tiberius (14-37 CE)

Tiberius was one of the most gifted men of his age – the most experienced and best possible successor to Augustus. His 23-year reign was crucial for consolidating the foundations laid by Augustus.

- Competent general and able administrator
 - Fought along the northern borders – regained standards lost by Crassus at Carrhae
 - Good with money – treasury 20X larger at the end of his reign
 - Conscientious
- However, Tiberius succeeded at 54 years old, and his life was primarily spent in army camps. He didn't possess good people skills, giving many people a dislike of him.
 - He was uneasy with senatorial aristocracy – was never able to develop a good working relationship with them, as Augustus was able
 - Lacking good communication skills – cause of much trouble. Having a solitary nature didn't help with communication either.
 - He could be grim, gloomy, suspicious
 - People of Rome were not impressed with him – he wouldn't waste money on 'bread and circuses'
- Sejanus, Tiberius' traitorous praetorian prefect, cause of much tragedy
 - Sejanus fed Tiberius' fears of plots and revolts
 - Sejanus was responsible for many executions by using and manipulating treason trials. He also led executions against the descendants of Augustus.
 - Tiberius eventually realized his treason – had Sejanus executed

- Tiberius named his great-nephew Gaius (Caligula) and grandson Tiberius Gemellus as joint heirs.
- His reign served as a bridge between the personal system of Augustus and the formally established imperial system of the future

Caligula (37-41 CE)

Gaius, better known by nickname Caligula, “little booties” – as a boy in his father’s army camp, he liked to wear a miniature version of military sandals (caligae)

- He succeeded as sole ruler – senate granted full imperial powers, but soon regretted that decision
- It started well but quickly changed into Caligula the Monster
 - He spent most of his fortune within a year
 - Mentally unstable, cruel, enjoyed inflicting pain and humiliation
 - Ordered men to be killed “so that they could feel they were dying”
- Assassinated by a coalition of some senators and Praetorian Guards
 - Praetorian Guard proposed Claudius as successor

Claudius (41-54 CE)

Claudius had been kept in the shadows (afflicted with some physical impairment that caused him to limp, stammer, and drool) because image was essential to the imperial family. But his intellect was not impaired at all – he was quite intelligent and scholarly.

After the death of Caligula (1st open murder of an emperor), the Praetorian Guard acclaimed Claudius as emperor.

- This was the first time it was made plain that the emperor’s position was based on the army’s support rather than the Senate’s consensus. (It always was, but Augustus had disguised it in the trappings of Republican traditions).

Reign

- Roman expansion
 - 43-47 Conquest of southern Britain – a new province
- Imperial bureaucracy expanded
 - Increased the powers and functions of the imperial staff
 - The first era of the great imperial freedmen – Claudius relied on the ex-slaves, and a few rose to prominence
 - Aristocratic Senate resented the prominence of these ex-slaves
- Stories of his scheming wives overshadow his achievements

Claudius left a stable, well-governed empire – unfortunately, he named his step-son Nero heir to the throne

Nero (54-68 CE)

Stepson to Claudius, he came to the throne when 16 years old. He was young inexperienced, and his childhood was colored by morbid tensions and rivalries of the imperial family.

- Nero had a Hellenistic view of the position of an emperor – living in immense splendor, cultural patron, genuine interest in Greek art, poetry
- No military experience – leadership of army left to local commanders
- Gradually, Nero's activities became more sinister – a reign of terror ensued
 - Had his mother killed (because she spoke against him)
 - Wife Octavia killed
 - 64 – Rome burned. Nero blamed the Christians – persecuted them, burning many of the alive
 - Treason law revived, leading to at least 19 executions/suicides and 13 banishments
 - Nero, jealous of successful army commander Corbulo – ordered his suicide. 3 other provincial governors were killed.

When a revolt in Gaul occurred in 68, Nero panicked and went east. The Senate and Praetorian Guard proclaimed Galba emperor. Nero committed suicide – the last of the Julio-Claudians.

CE 69: The Year of 4 Emperors

Nero died without an heir – the imperial throne became a prize to be fought over. The year of CE 69 turned into a long year of revolt. An autocratic rule was now the established order – the senate did little more than react to events as they rolled out. Galba, Otho, and Vitellius were successively proclaimed emperors by their legions. Ultimately, it was Vespasian – a successful commander of provincial origin – who won the support of most of the armies.

Flavian Dynasty-

Vespasian personified a new phase in the development of the empire – one in which an emperor could come from outside the traditional noble families and make his way to power through merit.

Vespasian (69-79 CE)

Vespasian was the first emperor since Augustus to maintain good relationships with the Senate, the army, and the Roman populace. He was not pretentious (stressed his humble origins) and worked hard.

- Reestablished the economy based on sound fiscal policy
 - Treasury depleted due to the extravagance of Nero and the civil wars
- Aware of the empire's needs:
 - Stable provincial government
 - Definition of boundaries
 - Permanent barriers define German borders
 - Widening of citizenship – so that subjects are drawn into loyalty
- Colosseum construction began – capacity of 50,000

Vespasian was a good emperor, bringing peace and stability after the civil wars.

Titus (79-81 CE)

Vespasian's eldest son – his reign was short and calamitous:

- Eruption of Mt. Vesuvius – destruction of Pompeii and Herculaneum
- 3-day fire in Rome
- Plague epidemic

On the bright side - the Colosseum was finished!

- 100 days of inaugural games

Titus was a conscientious ruler and generous with aid relief during the catastrophic events that besieged Rome.

Domitian (81-96 CE)

Unfortunately, Vespasian's younger son did not follow in his or his brother's footsteps...

- Autocratic, arrogant, and meted out severe punishments
 - Cornelia (a vestal virgin) was walled up alive in an underground cell to die, while her lovers were beaten to death with rods
- Persecution of Jews – taxes levied on them for 'atheism' and 'godlessness'
- Executed/eliminated any potential rivals
 - Revived treason trials – brought charges against his praetorian prefect
- Emphasized that he was an absolute monarch
 - Domitian adopted the title "Lord and God."
 - Also, used imperator (emperor) as a title rather than princeps, which became conventional from this point forward for emperors

He had spent much of his reign with the army in Dacia and Germany. His strength lay in administration – he was a meticulous administrator, perhaps one of the empire's best administrators. But that was not enough to prevent his assassination by a coalition of senators, praetorian prefects, and members of his household.

5/11-12

Roman Empire Pompeii

Date 79 CE

Themes Trade and Commerce

Readings OxR Ch 16
Pompeii Buried Alive!

Pompeii was “one of the loveliest places on earth” ~ *Pliny the Younger*

Pompeii

Situated on the Bay of Naples - a prosperous city of ~20,000 people

- Wealthy from agriculture and associated products from the surrounding countryside of Campania
 - Wine and olive oil
 - Industry-related to the marketing of agricultural goods
 - Pottery for amphorae – to export wine, oil, and other products
 - Mid 1st century – wool processing was an expanding industry
- The city showcased its wealth
 - Temples, theaters, gymnasium, arena, gladiator school, public baths, hotels, taverns, indoor plumbing

August 24, 79 CE – Mt. Vesuvius blew its top

“On the landward side a fearful black cloud was rent by forked and quivering bursts of flame, and parted to reveal great tongues of fire, like flashes of lightning magnified in size...” ~ *Pliny the Younger*

- “firestorm” of poisonous vapors and molten debris engulfed the surrounding area – suffocating those who could not flee from Pompeii, Herculaneum, and Stabiae
 - Ash and falling debris filled the streets of Pompeii until nothing could be seen
 - ~90% people escaped – city buried under 20 feet of stones and ashes
 - Hot mud flowed through Herculaneum, covering the city
 - Because mud lava was slow-moving, most of the inhabitants escaped
 - The towns remained buried for almost 1700 years – until excavation began in 1748
- Mt. Vesuvius has erupted over 50 times since then – its last eruption was in 1944 during World War II

A Snapshot

Archaeologists have spent over 200 years excavating Pompeii. Two-thirds of the city has been uncovered, exposing a wealth of information about the everyday lives of Romans. Buildings, homes, art, and architecture are remarkably preserved – even the people themselves.

- Plaster casts have been made of the spaces created by people who died in the lava and ash. Lava and ash hardened around the bodies, but a hollow area was left when the body decayed, creating a mold. Plaster was injected into the spaces – in effect, casting or recreating the person/animal that died:
 - Children crouching in fear
 - Dogs running
 - Woman and 3 servants running with jewels
 - 18 people huddled in a wine cellar
- Graffiti covered walls
 - “Lovers like bees draw out the sweet life. I beg you, Venus, let my rival perish.”
 - “Hello Profit! Profit is joy!”
 - “The petty thieves urge you to elect Vatia aedile.”
 - “Vote for Lucius Popidius Sabinus; his grandmother worked hard for his last election and is pleased with the results.”

Recent excavation:

Several of the town’s temples were built on structures dated to the 6th century BCE.

An excavated *thermopolium* (snack bar) was opened to the public in August 2021. Rebecca Mead wrote about what she discovered -

- A masonry counter is decorated with expertly rendered and still vivid images:
- a fanciful depiction of a sea nymph perched on the back of a seahorse
- a tromp-l’oeil painting of 2 strangled ducks on the countertop, ready for the butcher’s knife
- a fierce-looking dog on a leash
- a representation of a snack bar, with earthenware vessels known as amphorae stacked against a counter laden with pots of food while a figure - the bar’s proprietor? – bustles in the background
 - Rich people had kitchens in their houses and banquet rooms and gardens. Most people didn’t live in such places – they had small apartments or one-room flats. During the day, their place was a workshop. At night the family would close up the front and sleep there. When they could afford it, they would go to a thermopolium and have a warm meal, and take their plate and eat it on the street.

Archaeologists use modern technologies and methodologies to analyze what was inside the cooking pots:

- Fragments of duck bone

- Sheep stew
- Fish
- Land snails
- Crushed fava beans

According to Sophie Hay, a British archaeologist who has worked extensively in Pompeii, they show more than the diet of the working classes – they shed new light on the rhythms of civic life. “There are Roman laws that said bars shouldn’t serve this kind of warm food, like hot meat, so we’ve been guided by the classical sources. Then, suddenly, there is this one bar that is definitely serving hot food. And is it the only bar in the Roman world to have done this? Unlikely.”

5/16-17

Roman Empire Trajan & Army

Date	96-117 CE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	Pompeii Buried Alive! OxR Ch 17

Five “Good” Emperors (96-180)

The next 5 emperors treated the ruling classes with respect, cooperated with the senate, ended arbitrary executions, maintained peace, and supported domestic policies beneficial to the state.

- The powers of the emperor were expanded at the expense of the senate
- Imperial officials took over running the government (appointed by the emperor)
- Period of extensive building programs – especially under Trajan and Hadrian

Nerva (96-98)

- Chosen after the assassination of Domitian
- Didn't have any sons – adopted Trajan

Trajan – Model Emperor (98-117)

“He was most conspicuous for his justice, bravery, and the simplicity of his habits...He did not envy or slay anyone, but honoured and exalted all good men without exception, and hence he neither feared nor hated any of them...He expended vast sums on wars and vast sums on works of peace; and while making very many urgently needed repairs to roads and harbours and public buildings, he drained no one's blood in any of these undertakings...” ~Dio Cassius

Background

- 1st non-Italian emperor - Family origins were from settler stock in Spain
 - Beginning with Trajan, provinces supplied many of the emperors
- Father was a consul and governor of Syria
- When Trajan was appointed emperor, he was governor of Upper Germany

During his reign

- Roman territory grew to its greatest size under Trajan
 - New province of Dacia
 - Trajan's Column depict scenes from his Dacian campaign
 - New province of Arabia

- Annexed Armenia
 - Mesopotamia
- Effective civilian administrator
 - Given title Optimus Princeps (best leader)
 - Didn't execute anyone – traitors exiled
 - Wanted to guide, not control
 - Confirmed privileges of the senate
 - Attended to the material needs of the people – grain supply, financial subsidies for poor children
- Public Works Programs
 - Great network of roads and bridges throughout the empire
 - Trajan's Baths – exceeded anything built before
 - Trajan's Forum – included Greek and Latin libraries
 - Markets of Trajan
 - New harbor at Ostia

Role of the Army

1. Defense for frontiers- the primary instrument of defense for frontiers

- CE 14 – 28 legions
- Trajan – 30 legions (+ auxiliaries increased accordingly)
 - # of legions increased due to the expansion of the empire
- By 100 CE – only 1 in 5 legionaries were Italian (Italians reluctant to serve, so citizens from the provinces were recruited)

2. Provincial Role –

- Romanizing the provinces
 - Military camps spread Latin language and Roman institutions, ways of thought, and conduct
 - Development of trade and local products met the army's need for supplies
 - Urban centers developed around army bases and nearby colonies – which encouraged Romanization
- Maintain order in the provinces

3. Agent for upward mobility for officers and recruits

Standing army

- Maintained 30 legions now
 - Legion=5,400 soldiers (+non-combatants = 6,000 men/legion)
 - ~180,000 total men in army – (population of empire about 60 million)
 - 120 of the soldiers were cavalry
- Legionaries served 20 years

- Recruited from the citizenry – mainly from the provinces

Auxillary forces

From non-citizens in the provinces

- Served as light-armed troops, cavalry
 - Archers from Near East
 - Slingers from Majorca
 - Cavalry from Gaul and North Africa
- Served for 24 years (after which they and their families received full citizenship)

5/18-19

Roman Empire Public Entertainment: Gladiators & Circuses

Date	753 BCE - on
Themes	Trade and Commerce Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 28 (Gladiators) OxR Ch 18

~Seneca, describing a contest between criminals (the mid-day public execution interval between the wild beast show of the morning and the gladiatorial show of the afternoon):

"I chanced to stop in at a midday show, expecting fun, weight, and some relaxation, when men's eyes take respite from the slaughter of their fellow men. The preceding combats were merciful by comparison; now all trifling is put aside and it is pure murder. The men have no protective covering. Their entire bodies are exposed to the blows, and no blow is ever struck in vain. . . . In the morning men are thrown to the lions and the bears, at noon they are thrown to their spectators. The spectators call for the slayer to be thrown to those who in turn will slay him, and they detain the victor for another butchering. The outcome for the combatants is death; the fight is waged with sword and fire. This goes on while the arena is free. "But one of them was a highway robber, he killed a man!" Because he killed he deserved to suffer this punishment, granted. . . . "Kill him! Lash him! Burn him! Why does he meet the sword so timidly? Why doesn't he kill boldly? Why doesn't he die game? Whip him to meet his wounds! Let them trade blow for blow, chests bare and within reach!" And when the show stops for intermission, "Let's have men killed meanwhile! Let's not have nothing going on!"

Circuses

The Roman circus (hippodrome) was a large entertainment building used primarily for chariot racing but also for religious ceremonies, public feasts, and athletics

Circus Maximus

- Located in Rome – largest and the 1st to be built (according to tradition, during the rule of the Tarquins in the Age of Kings)
- Seated 150,000 spectators
 - Chariot racing
 - Oldest public entertainment
 - Regularly/frequently scheduled events (gladiatorial shows occurred less often)
 - Charioteers highly paid superstars with followers

- Chariots usually had 2 wheels, pulled by 4 horses. 4-12 chariots raced at a time. Race usually 7 laps – about 3 miles. Accidents frequently caused injuries and deaths.
 - 2nd century BC onwards – circuses also included beast hunts and athletic contests
- Monumental circuses were more common in the Western empire – rarer in the east

Gladiatorial Contests

During Republican Rome – at funerals

During Imperial Rome – at games, part of patronage of emperors

Role of the Gladiatorial Games in Roman Society:

Funeral ritual origins

- Gladiatorial contests were closely connected with funerals, rooted in the Etruscan custom of ritual human sacrifices to honor the dead. Fights to the death would be staged between prisoners of war at funeral games.
 - 264 BC – 1st gladiatorial contest presented by 2 nobles as part of a funeral ritual.
 - 3 pairs of slaves served as gladiators
 - 65 BC – Julius Caesar gave elaborate funeral games for his father using 640 gladiators and condemned criminals who were forced to fight with wild beasts
- Until the last century BCE, gladiatorial shows were sponsored by individual aristocrats in honor of dead relatives.

Politics

- Soon, the contests took on political overtones – fueled by competition between ambitious aristocrats looking to increase the number of their supporters.
- Provided an arena for popular participation in politics-
 - Cicero: “judgment and wishes of Roman people about public affairs can be most clearly expressed in three places: public assemblies, elections, and at plays or gladiatorial shows.”
- 42 BC – 1st-time gladiatorial games substituted for chariot races in official games

Imperial Rome

- Meetings of emperors and populace
 - Under the rule of emperors, citizens’ rights to engage in politics diminished. Shows provided opportunities for meetings between emperors and the massed populace (although emperors were skilled at stage-managing their appearance and reception)
 - Emperors received standing ovations and ritual acclamations.
 - Occasionally, the crowd voiced displeasure – to the high price of wheat, to high taxes, or desire to have an unpopular official executed
- Control of the populace

- Metropolitan control involved ‘bread and circuses’- “Roman people are held together by two forces: wheat doles and public shows” ~ Fronto, tutor of Marcus Aurelius

Games

- Took place in amphitheaters built throughout the empire
 - 1st permanent amphitheater built 29 BC
 - Colosseum largest and most famous, built by Vespasian and Titus
 - Inaugurated with 100 days of games and 3,000 gladiators
 - Trajan celebrated victory over the Dacians with 123 days of games and 10,000 gladiators
 - Where society invests its money shows its priorities – public slaughter was an important part of Roman culture
- Structure of the game day
 - Animal fights in the morning
 - Public executions – criminals fighting
 - Gladiator matches

Gladiators

- Slaves, criminals, or prisoners of war often trained as gladiators
 - Sometimes freedmen – would take an oath of willingness to be “branded, chained, whipped and killed by the sword.” A freeman’s motive to become a gladiator could be poverty or attraction to the excitement of the gladiator’s life. (Although most of the gladiators forced into that life probably wished their lives were not so exciting!)
- Were trained in ludi (gladiator schools) by lanistae (trainers)
- Common Gladiator Types
 - Retiarius – a net man, armed as a fisherman with a net, trident, and dagger, commonly fought secutor or murmillo.
 - Secutor – a pursuer, usually fought a retiarius. He wore an oval, smooth helmet designed to slip through the net of the retiarius.
 - Murmillo – a fish-man named for the high crest on his helmet, resembled a fish’s dorsal fin. He carried a short, stabbing sword (gladius) and oblong shield. Murmillos were paired against Thraces.
 - Thraces – carried a round shield, curved scimitar. Usually fought a murmillo.
- If a wounded gladiator could not continue fighting, he dropped his shield and appealed to the crowd. If he fought bravely, the crowd would shout “Mitle!” (“Let him go!”). If they felt he deserved to die, they made a stabbing gesture with their thumbs, crying “Iugula!” (“Kill him!”). The victorious gladiator would finish him off.
 - Although many fights ended in death, the defeated were often spared and lived to fight again.

Question – Why did Romans popularize fights to the death between gladiators? Why encourage the public slaughter of unarmed criminals? The answer may lie in several factors:

- The Roman empire was a by-product of centuries of war, discipline, and death
- Public punishment ritually reestablished moral and political order – the power of the state was dramatically reconfirmed
- The show provided a psychological and political safety valve for the metropolitan populace

5/23-5/24

Late Roman Empire Trade and Taxes

Date 284 CE begins Late Empire period

Themes Trade and Commerce
 Rise and Fall of Nations
 Conflict and Conquest

Readings SOTW Ch 40 (Rome Divided)
 OxR Ch 19, 22
 Roman Diary pp. 1-20

Late Roman Empire

Marcus Aurelius named his son Commodus co-emperor 3 years before his death. This was a break from the adoption of heirs that previous emperors used for succession. The beauty of adoption was that emperors could choose heirs based on qualities conducive to good governance. Aurelius' son Commodus was cruel – historian Cassius asserted that Commodus was “a greater curse to the Romans than any pestilence or crime,” This cruelty earned him death by assassination. It was said, by admirers of Aurelius, that the appointment of Commodus as emperor was the only failure of Aurelius' life.

Civil war ensued after the assassination of Commodus. The victor of the civil war was Septimus Severus, who in 193 AD established the Severan Dynasty, which held power until 235 AD.

Crisis of 3rd Century – Transformation of the Roman World

234-284 AD - Empire beset by invasions

- Eastern frontier – Sassanid Persians
- Northern frontier – Goths, Franks, Saxons, Alamanni, Sarmatians
 - Goths overran the Balkans, moved into Greece and Asia Minor
 - Franks moved into Gaul and Spain

Period of major instability

- 22 emperors in 50 years
- Power struggles between rival commanders
- The population decreased by a third – a result of invasions, civil wars, plague
- Manpower shortage affects military recruitment and economy
- Monetary system almost collapsed – coinage debased, hoarding of old coins

However-

- Cities in the east generally appeared more resilient

- Prosperity continued in less vulnerable areas of the empire
- Overall, despite instability, the empire proved resilient

Late Antiquity begins...

Pri/Int: Rome Divided in Two

Diocletian

Romans began to regain the initiative with emperors Aurelian and Carus. There was a partial resolution to the 3rd-century 'crisis', but many problems remained when Diocletian came to power. However, Diocletian was able to stay in power for 20 years. This proved to be enough time to reform and restructure the empire in a form that would last another 200 years in the west and much longer in the east.

Diocletian's Reforms

Empire Divided - Tetrarchy and Succession

Diocletian believed imperial duties were better shared – the empire was too large for one man to rule. The new administrative system called a Tetrarchy formed:

- 2 Augusti (emperors)
 - Diocletian named fellow commander Maximian to rule as joint Augustus.
 - Diocletian ruled the east; Maximian ruled the west. New administrative capitals were assigned to each part of the empire.
- 2 Caesars – successors to the emperors
 - Two years later, Constantius and Galerius were added as Caesars, designated as successors to the Augusti

Each tetrarch was given a sphere of the empire to oversee. Between the 4 of them, they quelled the Germans, dealt with local insurgents, and defeated the Persians = resulting in peace on the eastern frontier for decades to come.

Business and Trade in Roman Empire

The Roman economy was dependent upon the land – mainly an agricultural economy, from which most cities supported themselves

Trade Routes

- Overland – slowest, most expensive
- Water – by river or sea
 - By sea, the least expensive
 - Sea transport crucial for heavy goods

Most trade was in everyday commodities

- Grain, olive oil, wine, preserved fish
- Animal skins, wool
- Glass, pottery, metalware

Luxury goods

A smaller market – only a small proportion of the population could afford such purchases

- Precious metals, ironwork, olive oil – Spain
- Ivory – east Africa
- Incense, myrrh – Arabia
- Amber – Baltic coast
- Pepper – south India
- Purple dye – Syria

(When Alaric forced a ransom from Rome in 408, he demanded 3,000 lbs of pepper and 4,000 silk garments)

Taxes and Administration in the Provinces

Once Rome conquered land and made it a Roman province – governors, tax collectors, and peacekeeping forces were brought in to administrate the province

- Border provinces – more vulnerable
 - Governor appointed by the emperor, as his legate, for a 3 yr term
- Senatorial provinces – less vulnerable
 - Appointed by lot from a pool of senators with seniority

Governors were provided with a small staff to help with administration

- 2-3 junior senators, a quaestor
- Attendants, messengers, scribes, bodyguards

Once order is secure in a province, a census is made to provide a basis to assess for property tax and poll tax

- Other taxes (set relatively low)
- Inheritance tax for army discharge settlements
- On goods in transit (2-2.5%)
- Sales tax (1.5%)

5/25-5/26

Late Roman Empire Diocletian: Empire Divided

Date	284 CE begins Late Empire period
Themes	Trade and Commerce Rise and Fall of Nations Conflict and Conquest
Readings	SOTW Ch 39 (Emperor Christian) OxR Ch 26 pp 168-1 st paragraph 170 Roman Diary pp. 21-40

Late Antiquity begins...

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6/1-2

Late Roman Empire Constantine and Christianity

Date	306-337 CE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	SOTW Ch 41 (Attila) OxR Ch 24 pp. 161-162 Roman Diary pp. 41-61

Diocletian and Maximian abdicated/retired in 305. There is no parallel in Roman history for an abdication – it seemed implausible that an EMPEROR would choose to leave the throne.

Constantius, Caesar in the west became Augustus of the west. Galerius became the eastern Augustus. New Caesars were named: Severus in the west Maximinus in the east. (Constantine, son of Constantius, was never considered for the position of Caesar by either Diocletian or Maximian.)

A monkey wrench was thrown into the succession plans when Constantius unexpectedly died in 306. Instead of Caesar succeeding him, Constantius' troops in Gaul and Britain proclaimed his son Constantine as Augustus. Meanwhile, Maximian's son Maxentius proclaimed himself emperor.

- By 308 – 7, rival emperors were contending for power

Rise of Constantine

Constantine was born in 282 CE. He gained experience in his father Constantius' court as a youth before transferring to Diocletian's court.

- Constantine was well-traveled, mentioning that he saw Memphis and Babylon in his youth. This probably occurred when Diocletian suppressed a rebellion in Egypt and ended a war in Persia.
- While campaigning, Constantine learned the art of war. When not on campaign, Constantine continued his education in Greek and Latin, learned how government worked, and how to work with people in a large bureaucracy.

In 302, Diocletian had decided to persecute Christians by expelling all from imperial service that refused to offer a sacrifice to Roman gods. By 302, Christians had been in imperial service for 40 years already. But Diocletian and his Caesar Galerius wanted them expunged.

- This edict was unevenly enforced in the empire. It was enforced in the eastern empire under Diocletian and Galerius, but it was not strongly enforced in the west under Constantius, the western Caesar. Constantius was well disposed towards Christians. Constantine possessed the same attitude towards Christians.

308 CE – Constantine among the many contenders fighting to become emperor.

310 CE – Constantine is fighting his way to Rome. He stops at the shrine of Apollo Grannus in Gaul (France). While in the shrine, Constantine had a light-filled vision. The god Apollo himself appeared to Constantine. Constantine claimed that the god promised him victory, rule over the empire, and decades of life. Apollo is related to the sun god Sol Invictus. (Sun god often related to Christ.) Constantine mints coin celebrating his god Sol Invictus. Constantine is convinced that he is doing his god's will and that it was god's will to be the ruler.

312 CE – Battle of Milvian Bridge

- Constantine advances upon Rome. He meets Maxentius at the Milvian Bridge, a bridge over the Tiber River in northern Rome.
- Constantine's men were bearing on their shields a new symbol that combined the Greek letters Chi and rho – it could either be a reference to Christ or chrestos (good luck).
 - This symbol didn't have a Christian connotation on this day of battle but instead was used to raise morale. However, later this symbol would be used as a symbol of imperial Christianity.
 - Stories would circulate later that Constantine became a Christian at this time because of a vision in the sky of a cross with the words "in this sign, conquer."
 - But Constantine had started his spiritual journey towards conversion before this battle. It was a gradual conversion. Historian David Potter describes Christ as Constantine's god of "private moments," a god Constantine 'met on his own who provided him with guidance on an intensely personal basis'. At first, Constantine didn't believe that he needed to abandon other gods when he began to follow the Christian God.
 - Potter sees Constantine's conversion not as a sudden revelation but a journey over time, in his mind.
- Decisive battle – Constantine was victorious as the western emperor. Maxentius drowned in the Tiber.
 - Constantine enters Rome as the victor – senate voted him a triumphal arch
 - The panel showing the battle depicts Constantine looking at Maxentius falling into the Tiber as goddess Victory, beside Roma, beckons to him.
 - Constantine is also shown making a sacrifice to Diana, and a representation of the sun god is shown by his head. At this time, Constantine follows both the Sun god and Christian God. (In some Christian communities, the sun god is already equated with Christ).
 - Constantine remodels Rome to reflect his victory:
 - Renovated Temple of Venus and Roma
 - Church of Santa Croce
 - Basilica Constantiniana (now Church of San Giovanni in Laterano) – celebrates Constantine's God and victory

- Colossus

313 CE – Edict of Milan – Tolerance for all religions

What is incorrectly known as the Edict of Milan was a restoration edict issued by Licinius (Eastern Emperor) at Nicomedia on June 13, 313. Licinius declared that it encompassed his discussions with Constantine at Milan the previous year. Licinius wrote a letter to the governors of the eastern provinces stating that Christians are no longer to be persecuted and that Christians are protected by the Highest God who has aided them in their victories. All who worshipped the gods were to be treated equally.

- Significantly, it was written by a pagan emperor. He decided that Constantine had the correct way to deal with the “Christian question.”

From Lactantius Liber de Mortibus Persecutorum: Constantine and Licinius

proclaimed “that it was proper that the Christians and all others should have liberty to follow that mode of religion which to each of them appeared best; so that that God, who is seated in heaven, might be benign and propitious to us, and to every one under our government. And therefore we judged it a salutary measure, and one highly consonant to right reason, that no man should be denied leave of attaching himself to the rites of the Christians, or to whatever other religion his mind directed him, that thus the supreme Divinity, to whose worship we freely devote ourselves, might continue to vouchsafe His favour and beneficence to us..... And we thought fit to be thus special in the things committed to your charge, that you might understand that the indulgence which we have granted in matters of religion to the Christians is ample and unconditional; and perceive at the same time that the open and free exercise of their respective religions is granted to all others, as well as to the Christians. For it befits the well-ordered state and the tranquillity of our times that each individual be allowed, according to his own choice, to worship the Divinity; and we mean not to derogate aught from the honour due to any religion or its votaries.”

- The “Edict of Milan” represents a HUGE change in the direction of imperial policy. It stopped the persecution of Christians and can be seen as the culmination of the traditional Roman tolerance for religious cults. Now, Christianity is associated with the ideology of imperial victory.
 - A significant turning point in western history - Constantine’s support for Christianity was crucial in establishing the religion’s respectability and ensuring its continued spread. The state also provided financial resources for building churches –
 - Constantine was responsible for the Church of the Holy Sepulchre at Jerusalem, built over the supposed burial place of Jesus.
 - Constantine saw the power of the Christian’s God as the reason for his victory at the Battle of Milvian Bridge. He may have had a genuine commitment to Christianity, but he didn’t reject paganism.
 - After Constantine’s conversion to Christianity, later emperors and the majority of their courtiers were Christian.

Christian Persecutions Before Edict of Milan

Rome didn't have a problem with what Christians believed but in their refusal to honor traditional Roman gods. Christians renounced other cults, including the imperial cult. (Refusal of converted soldiers to honor the cult of the emperor was especially intolerable).

- As early as 64 CE, Nero used Christians as a scapegoat for Rome's fire – but there was no empire-wide persecution against Christians
- Persecution – initially random/sporadic, but increased during the mid-3rd century and early 4th due to tensions during that period
 - Rome was in crisis – defeats of the empire (invasions and civil wars) suggested that the gods were deserting Rome. Christian refusal to sacrifice to the gods may have been seen as the reason for the gods' desertion.

324 – Constantine becomes sole emperor

- Licinius had been the eastern emperor since 308
 - 324 –Constantine's army defeated Licinius and his army. Constantine was now the sole emperor.

Emperor Constantine

Constantine was concerned with defending & financing the empire and securing a stable succession.

- Also, he was concerned for all of his subjects – Christians and pagans. A well-regulated society was vital to him, where people knew their place, including Christians.

325 – Council of Nicaea

- There was division in the Christian church over Arianism regarding the nature of the trinity. The debate initially started in the 3rd century, but it took the name of a charismatic priest named Arius.
- Constantine convened an ecumenical council when he was focusing on reconciling the western and eastern ways of doing business. He wanted unity in church doctrine. Constantine invited bishops from the eastern and western parts of the empire to Nicaea.

- Constantine wanted a universal creed – he put forth his version of a creed (known now as the Nicene Creed), reportedly composed by Hermogenes, a Cappadocian priest. It was a confession of faith.
- The bishops adopted Constantine's creed. It is probably the 'best-known utterance by a Roman emperor in the modern world.'

Founding of Constantinople

After becoming sole emperor, Constantine built a new capital

- He was not trying to replace Rome, but rather Nicomedia in Bithynia, and the principal seat of Licinius and Diocletian's capital. Constantine needed a base from which defense of the east could be directed.

He chose the ancient Greek town of Byzantium – named it New Rome, but it came to be known as Constantinople ('city of Constantine')

- Relatively close to Danube and Euphrates rivers
- Excellent roads for communication between the east and west
- Excellent harbor
- Located on the European side of Strait of Bosphorus – gave control over traffic to/from the Black Sea
- Easily defensible

"New Rome"

- Built a forum, large palaces, amphitheater
- Built Christian churches (Hagia Irene) and pagan temples
- Created a 2nd senate
- Gave special incentives to live there (free grain)
- Focus on education and arts
- A magnet for Christian visitors and pilgrims
- Inaugurated in 330 AD

Constantine died in 337

- Before he died, he had begun a war with Persia that lasted until 363 AD. Unfortunately for his heirs, it would be their fight for many years and a drain on the empire.

Historian David Potter on Constantine:

"Constantine changed the world not because he sought to, but because in seeking the power that was once Diocletian's, he understood the limits of that power. And the impact of this most influential figure in the history of Christianity was profound precisely because he did not try to force his beliefs on others.....The Roman people knew what was fair and what was not, and this emperor

knew he must always respect the values of the ruled and act accordingly. To the best of his ability, not always wisely, not always successfully, but with consistency, this is what Constantine did.”

After Constantine, the emperors were Christian (except for Julian). Under Theodosius (378-395), Christianity was made the Roman Empire's official religion. All other religions were forbidden; pagans and heretics were persecuted.

6/6-7

Late Roman Empire Barbarian Invasions

Date	3 rd century – 476 CE
Themes	Conflict and Conquest Rise and Fall of Nations
Readings	SOTW Ch 41 (Stilicho, Visigoths) OxR Ch 25

Barbarians

'barbarian' comes from the Greek barbaros = 'foreigner' or 'sound foreigners make'; Latin used the Greek word to make barbaria = foreign country

- Greeks meant it for all who were not Greek, but the Romans applied it to tribes/nations without Greek or Roman accomplishments – ironically, the Greeks considered Romans barbarians

As Republican and early Imperial Rome expanded its borders northward and westward into Gaul, Germany, Spain, and Britain, it came into contact with people who were not familiar with Roman or Greek culture-

- Such as Celts in Gaul (modern France), Germans north and east of Gaul

As the different barbarian cultures met and mingled with the Romans, 'romanization' occurred – army camps were an especially effective tool in spreading the Latin language, Roman institutions, and ways of thought and conduct

- Eventually, armies recruited barbarians to serve in the armies from all over the empire
 - Citizenship and all the benefits of citizenship for the recruit and his whole family served as a huge incentive
- In the 4th century, began hiring German tribes to fight other tribes or fight for Rome

Pressures on the borders

The vulnerability of the borders was apparent by the 2nd century, and in the 3rd century, it became a **crisis** -

- Threat from the north
 - Changes took place in northern and eastern Europe - population growth and the emergence of new, often expansionist, tribes pushed into the Germanic tribes along the Roman frontier.

- Pressure from the northern tribes made Roman lands quite attractive to the Germans.
- Mid-3rd century – Romans vulnerable along the northern frontier from Saxons, Franks, Alamanni, Sarmatians, and Goths
 - The Danube and Rhine rivers were breached – Goths reached Ephesus, Alamanni reached Milan, some German tribes made it to the Mediterranean Sea, even Spain and Mauritania before the borders were restored
- Threat from the east-
 - An aggressive Persian Sassanian empire extended into Armenia and Georgia – threatened Rome's eastern frontier
 - Emperor Valerian, in 260, was captured by Sassanian monarch – died in captivity

Late 4th century- German migrations

- 370s - Huns from Central Asia, escaping a drought, pushed into Germany – which then pushed German Goths into Roman lands
- Displaced Goths asked Emperor Valens for permission to cross Danube and farm in the Balkans in return for military services.
 - Valens agreed to this arrangement– but Roman military leaders mistreated them, leading to a revolt. The Visigoths defeated the Romans at Adrianople.
 - Visigoth = refers to Goths that settled south of the Danube; composed of different tribes bound to a common Gothic leader (in 380s, Alaric garnered widespread support)
 - Ostrogoth = refers to Goths that had stayed north of the Danube

Rome was losing the initiative with the invaders...

- THEN...The significant development in the relationship between Romans and barbarians:
 - General Theodosius became emperor in 379
 - Unable to expel the Visigoth invaders and immigrants, he made a treaty with them –allowing them to settle in the empire (Thrace) in return for providing troops for the army
 - Exempt from taxation; all-German troops able to serve under their leaders
 - Considered “federates” or allies of Rome. 1st time an area within Roman borders passed out of effective control of Rome

Date	395-476 CE
Themes	Rise and Fall of Nations Conflict and Conquest
Readings	OxR Ch 26, Epilogue SOTW Ch 42

The fall of the Western Roman Empire happened gradually-

Empire Split

395 CE – Theodosius died. His sons are declared joint emperors:

- Arcadius – emperor of the eastern part of the empire
- Honorius – emperor of the western part of the empire

The 2 halves were never to be reunited

Split consolidated by various forces:

Eastern Empire (remained intact) –

- Administrative language Greek
- More buoyant economy – controlled trade with Arabia, China, and India
 - Included rich Egyptian lands
- Higher population – could support a larger army
- More defensible borders
- Less intractable enemies
- Luck that emperors lived longer in the east and were more resolute

Western Empire (gradually collapsed) –

- Foreign invasions continued – Romans forced out of the provinces by the mid-5th century
 - Visigoths move into Italy – then into SW Gaul, Spain, and Portugal
 - Alaric sacks Rome in 410 CE
 - Vandals under Gaiseric move into Gaul, Spain, then into North Africa
 - Gaiseric sacks Rome in 455 CE
 - Germanic Angles, Jutes, Saxons move into Britain – Roman troops leave Britain in 410 CE
 - Sueves settled in northwest Spain
- Western empire was unable to launch military campaigns with its troops –

- Germans had served as mercenaries for centuries, and now whole contingents of Franks and Goths served under Frank and Goth commanders
- Imperial rule was unstable due to infighting, causing low-grade civil wars
- Diminishing wealth
 - Predominantly an agricultural economy (whereas the Eastern empire had a vibrant trade economy with Arabia, China, and India)
 - Loss of eastern tax money when empire divided in 395 CE

When the 'Fall' came – it was not a major or unexpected event

Final Years 455-476 CE

- Roman administration gradually disintegrated.
- Survival depended on volatile allies who had no interest in remaining loyal allies when they had a chance to extend their lands.
- Italy vulnerable to attack from the sea

Last Roman emperor in West

Romulus Augustus (r. 475-476 CE)

A young boy who was on the throne for less than a year

- 476 CE – Romulus deposed by Odoacer (a German officer who had served under Romulus' father)
 - Odoacer did allow him and his family to live – supported in a palace in Campania

Signaled the end of the Western Roman Empire – but the Eastern Roman Empire survived for another thousand years as the Byzantine Empire, falling in 1453 CE

(The Byzantines themselves had referred to themselves as “Romans,” their state as the “Roman Empire,” and they were called “Rum” (Rome) by their eastern enemies. The term “Byzantine” was first used in 1557 by a German historian).

Coming to terms with New World

Despite the collapse of the old Roman administration, the local population adjusted to new Germanic rulers

- Changes may not have been huge since accommodations had been taking place for decades without significant disruption
 - Many incoming Germans already Romanized (through service in the army or trade contacts)

- Generally, systems of land ownership (with the accompanying tax revenue) stayed the same – relatively few cases of land dispossession
- Roman law remained – most German rulers adopted it for their Roman subjects
- Church survived with its administrative structure intact – played an important role as protector of the poor
- Business and administration was conducted in Latin

The overall economic picture does show an Italy in serious economic decline

- Most towns in the west were shells of what they had been
- In the northwest, towns virtually ceased to exist after 400 – reduced to markets for peasant exchanges
- Communities now centered on courts of Germanic kings or monasteries
- Now a rural world with narrower horizons

Legacy of Ancient Rome

The Roman Empire was one of the largest empires, and most influential the world has ever seen. More than 2,000 years later, we still see evidence of ancient Rome throughout the western world today.

Great Builders-

Demonstrated exceptional coordination of men and resources before modern machinery

- Roads
- Aqueducts
- Public baths
- Basilicas
- Bridges
- Harbors
- Colosseum and other amphitheaters

New technologies and innovations made their massive building projects possible-

- Concrete – discovered that lime +volcanic ash created a durable concrete that sets underwater
 - June 2013 - Berkeley Lab scientists released results of their research into the exact composition of Roman concrete, stating that it could replace 40% of the world's demand for Portland cement. (Our modern concrete lasts 50-100 years, whereas Roman concrete has shown a 2,000-year track record and is still going strong!)
- Domes – an architectural innovation
- Arches – an architectural innovation
- Sewage systems

- Central heating systems
- Roman architecture inspired 18th-century architecture, seen in:
 - White House and Capitol in Washington, D.C.
 - Bank of England in London
 - Old Museum in Berlin

Roman art

- Mosaics
- Cameos
- Sculpture – copied/preserved Greeks' sculpture

Government/Civic Administration

- Politics
 - The structure of the Roman Republic influenced the writers of the US Constitution, especially the idea of checks and balances
 - Concept of state – “Kaiser” and “Czar” from Caesar
- Law
 - Laws in today's democracies evolved from ancient Roman and Byzantine laws – rights to own property, make contracts, wills
 - The general structure of jurisprudence- trial with a judge, plaintiff, and defendant- was established in ancient Rome
 - Roman law was based on Justice and Rights of the Individual: citizens had the right to equal treatment under the law. – (this inspired American and French democracies)
 - Romans gave us the belief that a man is innocent until proven guilty; a man should not be accused anonymously, and a man should not be penalized for what he thinks

Language

- Latin flourished as a language because it was the language of the Catholic Church, and the learned used Latin well into the Baroque period
- Latin is the basis of modern languages: Italian, French, Portuguese, Spanish, Romanian
 - English – over 50% of the words Latin/Romance language origin
- Science – scientific names of species are in Latin or Latinized

Script - Latin alphabet is the most used script

Codex – book format used today, was invented by the Romans for the Bible

Religion

- Roman empire had a significant role in spreading Christianity through the Western Roman Catholic Church and the Eastern Orthodox Church

Literature – a few examples

- Virgil – the epic Aeneid
- Cicero – oratory
- Marcus Aurelius Meditations – Stoic philosophy
- Ovid
- Seneca
- Livy – historian
- Tacitus

Many areas of modern life still carry the mark of the Roman Empire

Abbreviations for Resource Books

SOTW	Story of the World Volume 1: Ancient Times Susan Wise Bauer
OxNE	The Ancient Near Eastern World Amanda Podany & Marni McGee (Oxford Univ. Press)
OxE	The Ancient Egyptian World Eric Cline & Jill Rubalcaba (Oxford Univ. Press)
OxG	The Ancient Greek World Jennifer Roberts & Tacy Barrett (Oxford Univ. Press)
OxR	The Ancient Roman World Ronald Mellor & Marni McGee (Oxford Univ. Press)
AEN	Ancient Egypt and Her Neighbors Lorene Lambert
WR	Usborne Encyclopedia of World Religions Susan Meredith & Clare Hickman

Bibliography of Books used in Overviews 2021-2022

Alexander, Caroline	The War That Killed Achilles
Amos, H. D. & Lang, A. G.	These Were the Greeks
Amos, H. D. & Lang, A. G.	These Were the Romans
Bahn, Paul G.	The Atlas of World Archeology
Baines & Malek	Cultural Atlas of Ancient Egypt
Bauer, Susan Wise	The History of the Ancient World
Bowker, John	World Religions The great faiths explored and explained
Cartledge, Paul	Ancient Greece A Short Introduction
Dio Cassius	Roman History Books 1-11 Loeb Classical Library
Clark, Gillian	Late Antiquity A Very Short Introduction
Falcon & Blatnor	Judaism For Dummies
Freeman, Charles	Egypt, Greece and Rome Civilizations of the Ancient Mediterranean
Fox, Robin Lane	The Classical World An Epic History from Homer to Hadrian
Goldsworthy, Adrian	In the Name of Rome
Grant, Michael	The Roman Emperors
Hamilton, Edith	The Echo of Greece
Hamilton, Edith	The Roman Way
Harper, Kyle	Slavery in the Late Roman World AD 275-425
Haywood, John	The Penguin Historical Atlas of Ancient Civilizations
Heather, Peter	Goths
Heather, Peter	Empires and Barbarians
Heather, Peter	The Fall of the Roman Empire

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